

Challenge Tre3

Challenge Library, full review copy
345 challenges across 12 categories
Casuarina Consulting

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Water (30)

1. 5-minute shower

Difficulty 1 | 5 min | free | global

Limit your shower to 5 minutes today.

Instructions

- Set a timer before stepping in
- Turn off water while soaping up
- Step out when the timer ends

Why it matters: A 5-minute shower uses ~40 L less than a 10-minute one.

Tips

- Use a shower playlist timed to 5 min
- Turn off mid-lather

Barriers: Rushing, Hard to track time

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.05 kg | Water 30 L | Waste 0 kg

2. Fix a dripping tap

Difficulty 2 | 20 min | low | global

A dripping tap wastes up to 20 L/day. Fix it today.

Instructions

- Turn off supply under sink
- Replace the washer or cartridge
- Test for no drip

Why it matters: A single dripping tap wastes ~7,000 L per year.

Tips

- Most fixes cost under \$5
- YouTube covers every tap type

Barriers: Not comfortable with DIY

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.05 kg | Water 30 L | Waste 0 kg

3. Drink tap water all day

Difficulty 1 | 1 min | free | global

Skip bottled water and refill a reusable bottle from the tap.

Instructions

- Fill a 1-litre reusable bottle at home
- Refill wherever tap water is available
- Track how many refills you do

Why it matters: Each plastic bottle saved removes ~100g of CO₂ from production.

Tips

- Add lemon if you dislike the taste
- Filter jugs improve taste cheaply

Barriers: Taste preference, Availability at work

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.05 kg | Water 30 L | Waste 0 kg

4. Turn off tap while brushing

Difficulty 1 | 2 min | free | global

Don't let the tap run while you brush your teeth.

Instructions

- Wet brush, then turn tap off
- Brush for 2 minutes
- Turn on only to rinse

Why it matters: Leaving the tap on while brushing wastes 6 L per minute, up to 24 L per day.

Tips

- Put a reminder note on the mirror
- Use a cup to rinse

Barriers: Old habits

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.05 kg | Water 30 L | Waste 0 kg

5. Run a full dishwasher load

Difficulty 1 | 5 min | free | global

Only run the dishwasher when it's completely full.

Instructions

- Load every dish you have dirty
- Select eco mode if available
- Air dry instead of heated dry

Why it matters: A full dishwasher uses ~50% less water than hand-washing the same load.

Tips

- Scrape don't rinse before loading
- Use eco / half-load setting

Barriers: Not enough dirty dishes yet

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.05 kg | Water 30 L | Waste 0 kg

6. Collect rainwater for plants

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | low | global

Set up a bucket or barrel to collect rainwater and use it on your garden.

Instructions

- Place a large container under a downpipe or outside
- Cover with mesh to prevent mosquitoes
- Use collected water on plants this week

Why it matters: A 200 L rain barrel can offset 1,300 L of mains water over a dry summer.

Tips

- Food-grade buckets work perfectly
- A downpipe diverter is under \$20

Barriers: No outdoor space, Renting

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.05 kg | Water 30 L | Waste 0 kg

7. Take a navy shower

Difficulty 2 | 5 min | free | global

Wet yourself, turn off the water, soap up fully, then rinse, navy style.

Instructions

- Turn on water to get wet
- Turn off and apply soap and shampoo
- Turn back on only to rinse

Why it matters: Navy showers can cut water use to under 10 L, vs. 60-100 L for a standard shower.

Tips

- Takes getting used to on cold days
- Works best in warm bathrooms

Barriers: Cold rooms, Habit change

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.05 kg | Water 30 L | Waste 0 kg

8. Check for toilet leaks

Difficulty 1 | 5 min | free | global

Add food colouring to the cistern, if it reaches the bowl without flushing, you have a leak.

Instructions

- Drop food colouring in cistern
- Wait 15 minutes without flushing
- Check the bowl for colour

Why it matters: A leaking toilet can waste up to 400 L/day silently.

Tips

- Replace the flapper valve (usually \$5)
- Hardware stores stock all parts

Barriers: Renting, contact landlord

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.05 kg | Water 30 L | Waste 0 kg

9. Water plants at dawn or dusk

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Water your garden in the early morning or evening to reduce evaporation.

Instructions

- Check weather, skip if rain is forecast
- Water at base of plants, not leaves
- Do it before 9am or after 6pm

Why it matters: Watering in peak sun can waste 30% of water to evaporation.

Tips

- Mulch around plants to retain moisture
- Drip irrigation saves even more

Barriers: Forget in the morning rush

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.05 kg | Water 30 L | Waste 0 kg

10. Use leftover cooking water on plants

Difficulty 1 | 5 min | free | global

Let pasta or vegetable water cool, then use it to water your plants.

Instructions

- Cook as normal
- Set aside the unsalted/plain water
- Water plants once cool

Why it matters: Vegetable cooking water contains nutrients beneficial to plants.

Tips

- Don't use salted pasta water
- Works best on outdoor plants

Barriers: Forgetting to save it

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.5 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.3 kg

11. Shorten your laundry cycle

Difficulty 1 | 5 min | free | global

Use the quick or eco wash cycle on your washing machine today.

Instructions

- Sort laundry as usual
- Select quick wash or eco mode
- Wash only full loads

Why it matters: Eco wash cycles use up to 40% less water and 50% less energy.

Tips

- Modern detergents work in quick cycles
- Cold water is usually fine for most clothes

Barriers: Heavily soiled items

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.05 kg | Water 30 L | Waste 0 kg

12. Install a water-efficient showerhead

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | low | global

Replace your showerhead with a 3-star or better water-efficient model.

Instructions

- Buy a WELS 3-star or better showerhead
- Unscrew old head with an adjustable wrench
- Wrap new thread with plumber's tape and attach

Why it matters: A 3-star showerhead saves up to 9 L/min vs. a standard one, 3,000+ L/year for daily showers.

Tips

- Costs \$20-\$50 and pays back in months
- Many water utilities offer rebates

Barriers: Renting, Unsure how to install

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.05 kg | Water 30 L | Waste 0 kg

13. Wash fruit and veg in a bowl

Difficulty 1 | 5 min | free | global

Use a bowl of water to wash produce instead of running the tap.

Instructions

- Fill a bowl with clean water
- Wash produce in the bowl
- Pour the water on your garden

Why it matters: Running water to rinse veg uses 5-10 times more water than a bowl wash.

Tips

- Add a splash of white vinegar to remove residue
- Use the same water for multiple items

Barriers: Extra step

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.05 kg | Water 30 L | Waste 0 kg

14. Skip the car wash

Difficulty 1 | 1 min | free | global

Let your car stay dirty for another week, or use a waterless car wash product.

Instructions

- Check if your car genuinely needs washing
- If it does, use a bucket not a hose
- Or buy a waterless car wash spray

Why it matters: A hose-washed car uses 150-400 L. A bucket wash uses about 20 L.

Tips

- Park under trees reduces how often it needs washing
- Waterless sprays cost ~\$10 and last months

Barriers: Safety requires clear windscreen

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.05 kg | Water 30 L | Waste 0 kg

15. Insulate your hot water pipes

Difficulty 3 | 60 min | low | global

Wrap exposed hot water pipes with foam insulation to reduce wait time and water waste.

Instructions

- Buy foam pipe insulation from hardware store
- Measure and cut to length
- Clip onto exposed pipes under sinks and in laundry

Why it matters: Insulated pipes reach hot temperature faster, saving up to 2,000 L/year in wait water.

Tips

- Costs under \$20 for most homes
- Self-adhesive foam is easiest to install

Barriers: Access to pipes, Renting

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.05 kg | Water 30 L | Waste 0 kg

16. Mulch your garden beds

Difficulty 2 | 60 min | low | global

Apply 5-10cm of mulch around plants to retain soil moisture.

Instructions

- Buy or collect organic mulch (wood chip, straw, leaves)
- Clear weeds around plants
- Apply 5-10cm thick, leaving space around stems

Why it matters: Mulch reduces soil evaporation by up to 70%, cutting irrigation needs dramatically.

Tips

- Council green waste programs often give free mulch
- Leaves from your garden are free and effective

Barriers: Cost of mulch, No garden

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.05 kg | Water 30 L | Waste 0 kg

17. Track your water bill

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Read your water meter or bill and identify your biggest usage area.

Instructions

- Find your water meter or last bill
- Note your average daily usage in litres
- Identify the area where you use most (shower, garden, etc.)

Why it matters: Awareness alone reduces water use by 5-15% in most households.

Tips

- Many utilities have apps for tracking usage
- Compare to your country's average household usage

Barriers: Bills come quarterly

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.05 kg | Water 30 L | Waste 0 kg

18. Install a dual-flush toilet converter

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | low | global

Convert a single-flush toilet to dual flush with a retrofit kit.

Instructions

- Buy a dual-flush retrofit kit (most are universal)
- Follow kit instructions to replace cistern mechanism
- Test both flush options

Why it matters: A 9 L flush vs. 3 L half flush saves 6 L every time, 12,000 L/year for two people.

Tips

- Kits cost \$15-\$30 and are reversible
- Most landlords are happy with this upgrade

Barriers: Renting, Unsure of installation

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.05 kg | Water 30 L | Waste 0 kg

19. Use grey water on the garden

Difficulty 2 | 20 min | free | global

Redirect water from your laundry or shower onto your garden using a bucket or hose diverter.

Instructions

- Bail laundry rinse water into buckets
- Carry to garden or connect hose to laundry outlet
- Use on ornamental plants, not vegetables

Why it matters: An average washing machine uses 50-100 L per cycle, all of it can go on the garden.

Tips

- Use plant-based detergents which are garden-safe
 - Avoid grey water on edible plants
- Barriers:** Physical effort, Rental plumbing restrictions

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.05 kg | Water 30 L | Waste 0 kg

20. Take a 2-minute shorter shower

Difficulty 1 | 5 min | free | global

Whatever your normal shower time, cut it by 2 minutes today.

Instructions

- Note what time you usually get out
- Set a timer 2 minutes earlier
- Stick to it

Why it matters: Cutting 2 minutes from a daily shower saves over 7,000 L per year.

Tips

- Start a new habit, same song every day as a timer
- Dry shampoo on alternate days extends wash intervals

Barriers: Habit, Hair wash days

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.05 kg | Water 30 L | Waste 0 kg

21. Choose plants suited to your climate

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | low | global

Research one drought-tolerant or native plant and replace a thirsty ornamental.

Instructions

- Identify one high-water plant in your garden
- Research a native or drought-resistant alternative
- Plant or pot the replacement

Why it matters: Native plants adapted to local climate typically need 50-75% less water than exotic ornamentals.

Tips

- Your local native plant nursery can advise
- Succulents thrive in most dry climates

Barriers: Renting, Attachment to existing plants

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.05 kg | Water 30 L | Waste 0 kg

22. Use a broom, not a hose

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Sweep your driveway, path, or patio instead of hosing it down.

Instructions

- Get out a broom or blower
- Sweep all debris into a pile
- Bag it or compost it, no water used

Why it matters: Hosing a driveway uses 100-200 L. A broom uses zero.

Tips

- Keep a broom by the door as a visual cue
- Leaf blowers work but use energy

Barriers: Large surface areas

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.05 kg | Water 30 L | Waste 0 kg

23. Let grass grow longer

Difficulty 1 | 5 min | free | global

Raise your mower height by one setting, longer grass retains more moisture.

Instructions

- Adjust mower cutting height up one notch
- Mow less frequently
- Let clippings stay on the lawn as mulch

Why it matters: Longer grass shades soil, reducing evaporation by 30-50% and cutting irrigation needs.

Tips

- Aim for 7-10cm in summer
- Longer grass also crowds out weeds

Barriers: HOA or body corporate rules

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.05 kg | Water 30 L | Waste 0 kg

24. Turn off the ice maker

Difficulty 1 | 5 min | free | global

Switch off your fridge's ice maker if you don't need ice daily.

Instructions

- Locate ice maker switch in freezer
- Turn off or set to off position
- Reactivate when you need ice for an event

Why it matters: Ice makers use 3+ L of water per day and significant electricity even when unused.

Tips

- Fill an ice tray if you need occasional ice
- Turn it back on a few hours before a party

Barriers: No accessible switch

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.05 kg | Water 30 L | Waste 0 kg

25. Defrost food in the fridge overnight

Difficulty 1 | 1 min | free | global

Plan ahead and defrost frozen food in the fridge rather than under running water.

Instructions

- Move frozen item to fridge the night before
- Allow 8-12 hours for thawing
- Cook within 24 hours of full thaw

Why it matters: Running cold water to defrost uses 5-10 L per kilogram of food thawed.

Tips

- Put defrosting items on a plate to catch drips
- Label food with the date you moved it

Barriers: Forgetting to plan ahead

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.05 kg | Water 30 L | Waste 0 kg

26. Install a tap aerator

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Fit a flow-restricting aerator on your kitchen or bathroom tap to cut flow by 50%.

Instructions

- Unscrew the existing aerator on the tap spout
- Buy a 4-6 L/min aerator (under \$5)
- Screw on the new aerator

Why it matters: A standard tap flows at 15 L/min. A good aerator reduces this to 4 L/min without noticeable difference.

Tips

- Most taps have a standard thread
- Hardware stores stock these in bulk

Barriers: Renting, Odd-sized taps

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.05 kg | Water 30 L | Waste 0 kg

27. Don't pre-rinse dishes before dishwasher

Difficulty 1 | 1 min | free | global

Scrape plates clean with a spatula instead of rinsing under the tap.

Instructions

- Scrape food waste into compost or bin
- Load straight into dishwasher
- Use a good detergent, rinsing is unnecessary

Why it matters: Pre-rinsing wastes 10-20 L per load and modern dishwashers clean better without it.

Tips

- Enzymes in detergent need food particles to activate
- Only soak really stuck-on items

Barriers: Old habits, Concern about cleaning performance

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.05 kg | Water 30 L | Waste 0 kg

28. Fill the kettle only as much as you need

Difficulty 1 | 1 min | free | global

Boil only the water you need for each cup rather than a full kettle.

Instructions

- Measure water for the number of cups needed
- Mark your usual level with a rubber band
- Boil only what you need

Why it matters: Over-boiling a kettle wastes energy and water, adding 20g CO₂ per unnecessary boil.

Tips

- Most kettles have cup measurements on the side
- Keep water level above the heating element

Barriers: Habit of filling full

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.05 kg | Water 30 L | Waste 0 kg

29. Hand-wash clothes in a basin

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | free | global

Wash lightly soiled items by hand in a basin instead of running the machine.

Instructions

- Fill basin with cool water and a small amount of detergent
- Agitate clothes gently for 5 minutes
- Rinse in fresh water and hang to dry

Why it matters: A full machine cycle uses 50-100 L and 0.5-1 kWh. A hand wash uses ~15 L and no electricity.

Tips

- Ideal for delicates, gym clothes, and lightly worn items
- Use leftover basin water on garden

Barriers: Physical effort on larger items

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.05 kg | Water 30 L | Waste 0 kg

30. Use a pool cover

Difficulty 1 | 5 min | low | global

Cover your pool when not in use to prevent evaporation.

Instructions

- Pull cover over pool when not swimming
- Secure edges to prevent wind removal
- Remove and store properly when swimming

Why it matters: An uncovered pool loses 1,000-2,000 L per week to evaporation in summer.

Tips

- Solar covers also warm water and cut heating costs
- Covers pay for themselves within one season

Barriers: No pool, Cover storage space

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.05 kg | Water 30 L | Waste 0 kg

Food (29)

1. Eat a plant-based meal

Difficulty 1 | 30 min | low | global

Replace one meal with a fully plant-based option today.

Instructions

- Choose a recipe with no meat, fish, or dairy
- Cook or order from a plant-based menu
- Note how it tasted

Why it matters: A plant-based meal produces 50-90% less CO₂ than an equivalent meat-based meal.

Tips

- Lentil dahl, stir-fry veg, or bean tacos are quick wins
- Many restaurants mark vegan options clearly

Barriers: Unfamiliar recipes, Family preferences

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1.5 kg | Water 300 L | Waste 0.1 kg

2. Cook a meatless Monday meal

Difficulty 1 | 40 min | low | global

Make Monday entirely meat-free.

Instructions

- Plan breakfast, lunch, and dinner without meat
- Prep ingredients the night before
- Share what you made on social media if you like

Why it matters: One meat-free day per week saves the equivalent CO₂ of driving 500 km/year.

Tips

- Pasta, curries, and soups are easy meat-free wins
- Swap meat for legumes 1:1 in most recipes

Barriers: Household members who insist on meat

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1.5 kg | Water 300 L | Waste 0.1 kg

3. Use up food before shopping

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Check your fridge, freezer, and pantry before buying anything new.

Instructions

- Open everything in your fridge and pantry
- List what needs using up urgently
- Plan meals around those items

Why it matters: 1/3 of all food produced globally is wasted, and food waste produces 8% of global greenhouse gases.

Tips

- The "eat me first" box in the fridge keeps things visible
- Google recipes by ingredients you have

Barriers: Unfamiliar with using odds and ends

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1.5 kg | Water 300 L | Waste 0.1 kg

4. Compost your food scraps

Difficulty 2 | 10 min | free | global

Start or use a compost system for your kitchen scraps today.

Instructions

- Collect vegetable peel, coffee grounds, eggshells
- Add to a compost bin, bokashi, or council organics bin
- Keep a small caddy on the bench for convenience

Why it matters: Food in landfill produces methane, 80× more potent than CO₂ over 20 years.

Tips

- Bokashi systems work in apartments
- Many councils offer subsidised compost bins

Barriers: No outdoor space, Smell concerns

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.5 kg

5. Buy local produce

Difficulty 1 | 30 min | low | global

Visit a farmers market or buy produce labelled as locally grown.

Instructions

- Find a local market or farm stall
- Choose items grown within 150km
- Ask the seller what's in season

Why it matters: Transport accounts for only 6% of food's carbon footprint, local buying matters most for freshness and supporting farmers.

Tips

- Markets often have cheaper prices than supermarkets
- Join a local food co-op or veg box scheme

Barriers: Market times don't suit schedule, Limited access in some areas

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1.5 kg | Water 300 L | Waste 0.1 kg

6. Eat seasonal fruit and vegetables

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Choose fruit and veg that's in season in your region today.

Instructions

- Look up what's in season locally
- Swap any out-of-season items in your trolley
- Try one seasonal ingredient you don't usually buy

Why it matters: Out-of-season produce is often grown in heated greenhouses or flown in, multiplying its carbon footprint 10-20×.

Tips

- Seasonal produce charts are available online by region
- In-season produce is also cheaper and tastes better

Barriers: Not knowing what's in season

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1.5 kg | Water 300 L | Waste 0.1 kg

7. Reduce beef to once a week

Difficulty 2 | 5 min | low | global

If you eat beef regularly, commit to having it only once this week.

Instructions

- Plan your meals for the week
- Replace beef in other meals with chicken, pork, fish, or legumes
- Notice the difference in cost

Why it matters: Beef produces 20-60 kg CO₂ per kg of meat, 10× more than chicken and 30× more than legumes.

Tips

- Lamb and goat also have high footprints
- Chicken and pork are much lower impact

Barriers: Cultural or family tradition, Taste preferences

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1.5 kg | Water 300 L | Waste 0.1 kg

8. Store food properly to prevent waste

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Reorganise your fridge using the FIFO method (first in, first out) to prevent food going off.

Instructions

- Pull older items to the front of every shelf
- Put new purchases behind
- Wrap loose produce in damp cloths to extend life

Why it matters: The average household wastes \$2,000-\$3,500 worth of food per year, mostly from poor storage.

Tips

- Herbs keep longer in a jar of water in the fridge
- Freeze bread before it goes stale

Barriers: Fridge too full to reorganise

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1.5 kg | Water 300 L | Waste 0.1 kg

9. Pack a zero-waste lunch

Difficulty 2 | 15 min | free | global

Prepare lunch using reusable containers, no single-use packaging.

Instructions

- Use beeswax wraps, glass containers, or stainless steel tins
- Avoid individually wrapped items
- Bring reusable cutlery and a water bottle

Why it matters: The average office lunch generates 100-200g of plastic packaging waste every day.

Tips

- Bento boxes make packing quick and organised
- Batch cook on Sundays to make packing easy all week

Barriers: No fridge at work, Time in the morning

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1.5 kg | Water 300 L | Waste 0.1 kg

10. Try fermented food at home

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | low | global

Make a simple fermented food, sauerkraut, yoghurt, or kimchi, at home.

Instructions

- Choose a simple recipe (sauerkraut needs only cabbage and salt)
- Prepare and pack into a jar
- Leave to ferment at room temperature for 3-7 days

Why it matters: Home fermentation extends food life, reduces packaging, and supports gut health.

Tips

- Sauerkraut takes 10 minutes to prepare
- Start with a small jar to experiment

Barriers: Fear of failure, Unfamiliar process

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1.5 kg | Water 300 L | Waste 0.1 kg

11. Make a soup from vegetable scraps

Difficulty 2 | 45 min | free | global

Collect vegetable offcuts in a bag in the freezer this week and turn them into stock or soup.

Instructions

- Save onion skins, carrot peel, celery tops in a freezer bag all week
- Simmer in water for 1 hour
- Strain and use as stock or add veg for soup

Why it matters: Vegetable scraps destined for bin have already used water and carbon to grow, using them fully respects that.

Tips

- Parmesan rinds add incredible flavour
- Freeze stock in ice cube trays for easy use

Barriers: No freezer space

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1.5 kg | Water 300 L | Waste 0.1 kg

12. Buy imperfect produce

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Choose wonky, blemished, or irregular-shaped fruit and vegetables.

Instructions

- Look for marked-down imperfect produce at the supermarket
- Or sign up for an imperfect produce delivery box
- Use as normal, taste is identical

Why it matters: Up to 30% of crops are rejected by supermarkets for cosmetic reasons and wasted before reaching shelves.

Tips

- Imperfect produce is often 30-50% cheaper
- Services like Oddbox and Imperfect Foods deliver it

Barriers: Supermarkets rarely stock it prominently

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1.5 kg | Water 300 L | Waste 0.1 kg

13. Freeze food before it expires

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Check use-by dates and freeze anything you won't eat in time.

Instructions

- Check all items in the fridge
- Label with today's date anything going in the freezer
- Freeze bread, meat, dairy, soups, and cooked meals

Why it matters: Freezing extends food life by months and produces zero waste versus binning it.

Tips

- Most cooked meals freeze well for up to 3 months
- Freeze ripe bananas for smoothies

Barriers: No freezer space

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1.5 kg | Water 300 L | Waste 0.1 kg

14. Reduce dairy today

Difficulty 1 | 5 min | low | global

Swap dairy milk for plant milk in your coffee, tea, or cereal.

Instructions

- Buy oat, soy, or almond milk
- Use it in place of dairy for all drinks today
- Notice how it tastes

Why it matters: Dairy milk produces 3× more greenhouse gas than oat milk and uses 9× more land.

Tips

- Oat milk foams best for coffee
- Soy milk is highest in protein

Barriers: Taste preference, Cost

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1.5 kg | Water 300 L | Waste 0.1 kg

15. Grow a herb on the windowsill

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | low | global

Plant a seed or seedling of basil, mint, or parsley in a small pot.

Instructions

- Buy a pot, soil, and herb seedling
- Plant and place on a sunny windowsill
- Water lightly every day

Why it matters: Growing even one herb reduces packaged herb buying and the plastic packaging that comes with it.

Tips

- Mint grows aggressively, keep in its own pot
- Basil loves sun and warm temperatures

Barriers: No sunny windowsill, Away from home frequently

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1.5 kg | Water 300 L | Waste 0.1 kg

16. Plan a week of meals

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | free | global

Plan all meals for the next 7 days before doing any shopping.

Instructions

- List every meal: breakfast, lunch, dinner
- Write a shopping list from the plan only
- Buy only what's on the list

Why it matters: Households that meal plan waste 25% less food than those that don't.

Tips

- Plan around what's already in the fridge and pantry
 - Repeat easy dinners to reduce decision fatigue
- Barriers:** Schedule unpredictability, Family preferences changing

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1.5 kg | Water 300 L | Waste 0.1 kg

17. Choose line-caught or MSC-certified fish

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | low | global

Check the sustainability certification of any seafood you buy today.

Instructions

- Look for the blue MSC label on packaging
- Or choose line-caught or pole-caught options
- Avoid farmed prawns and trawled fish

Why it matters: Bottom trawling disturbs seabeds and produces 1.5 billion tonnes of CO₂/year globally.

Tips

- Sardines, mussels, and oysters are among the most sustainable seafood
- Seafood Watch app rates species by region

Barriers: Limited availability in some areas

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1.5 kg | Water 300 L | Waste 0.1 kg

18. Eat mindfully without screens

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Eat at least one meal today with no phone, TV, or laptop, just the food.

Instructions

- Set phone face-down or in another room
- Eat slowly and notice flavours
- Pay attention to hunger and fullness cues

Why it matters: Mindful eating reduces food waste by 15-20% because people stop when full rather than when the plate is empty.

Tips

- Eat at a table rather than a couch
- This is especially powerful at breakfast

Barriers: Habit of multitasking

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1.5 kg | Water 300 L | Waste 0.1 kg

19. Make a smoothie from food scraps

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Blend overripe fruit, wilted spinach, or vegetable peel into a nutrient-packed smoothie.

Instructions

- Collect any about-to-expire fruit and greens
- Blend with water, milk, or yoghurt
- Drink immediately or freeze in portions

Why it matters: Overripe bananas, browning spinach, and soft berries are perfect blending candidates.

Tips

- Add a date or honey for sweetness
- Frozen smoothies keep for 2 months

Barriers: No blender

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1.5 kg | Water 300 L | Waste 0.1 kg

20. Buy bulk dry goods

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | low | global

Buy grains, legumes, or nuts in bulk to reduce packaging waste.

Instructions

- Find a bulk food store or zero-waste shop
- Bring your own containers or bags
- Buy 1-2 weeks' worth of staples

Why it matters: Bulk buying eliminates packaging and often costs 20-40% less per kilogram.

Tips

- Oats, lentils, rice, and nuts are perfect bulk buys
- Many health food stores have bulk sections

Barriers: No bulk store nearby, Storage space at home

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1.5 kg | Water 300 L | Waste 0.1 kg

21. Read food labels for palm oil

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Check the ingredient list on 5 products today and identify which contain palm oil.

Instructions

- Check crisps, chocolate, margarine, and biscuits
- Look for palm oil, palmitate, palmolein in ingredients
- Choose one alternative product without it

Why it matters: Palm oil production drives deforestation in Borneo and Sumatra, destroying habitat for orangutans and tigers.

Tips

- Apps like Palm Oil Scan identify products
- RSPO-certified palm oil is a better alternative if unavoidable

Barriers: Palm oil is in thousands of products

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

22. Cook from scratch today

Difficulty 2 | 60 min | low | global

Make at least one meal entirely from raw ingredients, no processed or packaged shortcuts.

Instructions

- Choose a simple recipe (pasta sauce, curry, soup)
- Use whole ingredients, chop, peel, cook from scratch
- Note how it tastes vs. packaged versions

Why it matters: Highly processed foods generate 3-4× the packaging waste and 60% more carbon than home-cooked equivalents.

Tips

- Batch cook to make from-scratch viable on weeknights
- One-pot meals are the easiest starting point

Barriers: Time, Cooking confidence

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1.5 kg | Water 300 L | Waste 0.1 kg

23. Share a meal with neighbours

Difficulty 2 | 60 min | low | global

Cook extra and share with a neighbour, or organise a shared meal.

Instructions

- Cook a double portion of your evening meal
- Knock on a neighbour's door with the extra
- Or organise a simple potluck for the street

Why it matters: Shared cooking reduces individual energy use by up to 60% and builds food security in communities.

Tips

- Many communities have Neighbourhood Eats or similar groups
- Even just dropping off soup to a neighbour counts

Barriers: Don't know neighbours, Dietary restrictions

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

24. Try meat from an alternative protein

Difficulty 1 | 30 min | low | global

Cook with jackfruit, seitan, tempeh, or a meat substitute for one meal.

Instructions

- Buy one alternative protein from the supermarket
- Follow a simple recipe
- Assess what you liked or didn't

Why it matters: Tempeh and seitan have complete protein profiles and produce 5-10× less CO₂ than beef.

Tips

- Jackfruit pulled "pork" is very convincing in tacos
- Marinate tempeh well, it absorbs flavour well

Barriers: Unfamiliar flavour and texture, Availability

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1.5 kg | Water 300 L | Waste 0.1 kg

25. Avoid plastic food packaging

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | free | global

Do your shopping today choosing only loose or cardboard-packaged produce.

Instructions

- Avoid items in plastic trays or plastic wrap
- Choose loose fruit and veg
- Opt for paper/cardboard boxes over plastic containers

Why it matters: The average person generates 185 kg of plastic packaging waste per year, much of it from food packaging.

Tips

- Bring reusable produce bags to avoid small plastic bags
- Markets typically have far less packaging than supermarkets

Barriers: Limited loose options in some supermarkets

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1.5 kg | Water 300 L | Waste 0.1 kg

26. Make your own condiments

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | low | global

Make one condiment at home, hummus, pesto, salsa, or guacamole.

Instructions

- Choose a simple recipe
- Use whole ingredients
- Store in a glass jar in the fridge

Why it matters: Homemade condiments use zero single-use packaging and typically contain fewer preservatives.

Tips

- Hummus takes 5 minutes in a blender
- Freeze extra pesto in ice cube trays

Barriers: Time, Cost of ingredients in small quantities

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1.5 kg | Water 300 L | Waste 0.1 kg

27. Donate unused pantry items

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Check your pantry for non-perishables you won't use and donate them to a food bank.

Instructions

- Look for items past 6 months old in your pantry
- Check they're within date
- Drop at a local food bank or food rescue collection point

Why it matters: Food banks divert tonnes of food from landfill and provide meals to people experiencing food insecurity.

Tips

- Tins, pulses, pasta, rice, and long-life milk are most needed
- Many supermarkets have food bank collection bins

Barriers: Not knowing where the local food bank is

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

28. Reduce food in packaging from fast food

Difficulty 2 | 5 min | free | global

Decline unnecessary packaging at a fast-food or takeaway order.

Instructions

- Skip the plastic bag
- Decline straws, plastic cutlery, and extra napkins
- Ask for no lid if you're eating in

Why it matters: Fast food is one of the largest sources of single-use plastic, billions of pieces of cutlery and straws discarded daily.

Tips

- Bring your own container to a takeaway if possible
- Some shops give a discount for BYOC

Barriers: Habit of just taking what's given

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1.5 kg | Water 300 L | Waste 0.1 kg

29. Learn what your country's food footprint is

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Research the average dietary carbon footprint in your country and compare to the global average.

Instructions

- Search "food carbon footprint [your country]"
- Read one article or report
- Note one area where your diet is above or below average

Why it matters: The average UK diet produces 2.5 tonnes CO₂/year, the US 2.7 tonnes, mostly from meat and dairy.

Tips

- BBC, WWF, and Our World in Data have great food footprint tools
- Try the WWF food calculator for a personalised result

Barriers: Overwhelming amount of information

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

Energy (29)

1. Switch off standby appliances

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Turn off all appliances at the wall that are on standby.

Instructions

- Walk through every room
- Switch off TVs, monitors, game consoles, and chargers at the wall
- Use a power strip to make it easier daily

Why it matters: Standby power accounts for 5-10% of household electricity use, roughly \$100-\$200 per year.

Tips

- Smart plugs can auto-cut standby at a set time
- Label power strips so everyone knows which to switch off

Barriers: Recording shows pausing, Clock resets

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.4 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

2. Wash laundry in cold water

Difficulty 1 | 5 min | free | global

Switch your washing machine to a cold water cycle today.

Instructions

- Select cold or 30°C on the machine dial
- Use a cold-water detergent
- Run a normal cycle

Why it matters: Heating water accounts for 90% of a washing machine's energy use. Cold washes are equally effective with modern detergents.

Tips

- Ariel Cold and similar detergents are formulated for cold
- Hot cycles are only needed for towels and heavily soiled items

Barriers: Stubborn stains

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.4 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

3. Line dry your laundry

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Hang your laundry to dry rather than using a tumble dryer.

Instructions

- Set up an outdoor clothesline or indoor drying rack
- Hang clothes immediately after washing
- Give items space for air circulation

Why it matters: Tumble dryers are the second most energy-intensive home appliance, one cycle uses as much power as 3 hours of TV.

Tips

- Indoor racks near a window work in cold weather
- Shape garments while wet to avoid ironing

Barriers: Apartment with no outdoor space, Rainy climate

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.4 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

4. Turn down your thermostat by 1°C

Difficulty 1 | 2 min | free | global

Reduce your heating thermostat by one degree today.

Instructions

- Find your thermostat
- Reduce by 1°C (e.g., 20°C to 19°C)
- Add a layer of clothing if cool

Why it matters: Every 1°C reduction in heating saves approximately 8-10% on your heating bill and CO₂ emissions.

Tips

- A programmable thermostat pays for itself in months
 - Heat the room you're in, not the whole house
- Barriers:** Other household members adjusting it back, Cold climates

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.4 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

5. Switch to LED light bulbs

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | low | global

Replace at least one incandescent or halogen bulb with LED today.

Instructions

- Check which bulbs in your home are old halogen or incandescent
- Buy the equivalent LED from a hardware store
- Swap it in

Why it matters: LED bulbs use 80-90% less energy than incandescent bulbs and last 15-25 times longer.

Tips

- LEDs come in all colour temperatures, choose warm white for living areas
- They pay back their cost in under 6 months of use

Barriers: Cost of buying multiple bulbs at once

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.4 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

6. Get a home energy audit

Difficulty 2 | 60 min | free | global

Book a free or subsidised home energy audit to identify efficiency improvements.

Instructions

- Search "[your council/state] home energy audit"
- Book an appointment or use an online self-audit tool
- Note the top three recommendations

Why it matters: A home energy audit typically identifies 20-40% in savings with targeted upgrades.

Tips

- Many utilities offer free audits to residential customers
- Even a DIY audit using your energy bills is worthwhile

Barriers: Time to arrange, Rental properties

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

7. Use a slow cooker instead of the oven

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Prepare tonight's meal in a slow cooker or pressure cooker instead of an oven.

Instructions

- Choose a recipe suited to a slow cooker (soups, stews, casseroles)
- Prep and set in the morning
- Let it cook on low for 6-8 hours

Why it matters: A slow cooker uses 0.2 kWh over 8 hours vs. 2+ kWh for an oven, up to 90% less energy.

Tips

- Batch cooking in a slow cooker saves time all week
- Pressure cookers are even faster with similar savings

Barriers: Don't own one, Unfamiliar recipes

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.4 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

8. Unplug your phone charger when done

Difficulty 1 | 1 min | free | global

Unplug your phone charger as soon as your phone is full, and don't leave it plugged in overnight.

Instructions

- Set phone to charge before bed
- Set an alarm to unplug it before you sleep or when it's full
- Unplug at 100%, not next morning

Why it matters: Phone chargers draw phantom power even when nothing is charging, and charging past 80% reduces battery life.

Tips

- Charge during the day when you're awake to monitor it
- Smart plugs can auto-cut power at 100%

Barriers: Overnight charging is habitual

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.4 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

9. Use natural light today

Difficulty 1 | 5 min | free | global

Work or spend time by a window and avoid turning lights on until after dark.

Instructions

- Open blinds and curtains first thing
- Position your desk or work area near natural light
- Only switch lights on after sunset

Why it matters: Artificial lighting accounts for 15% of a typical home's electricity use.

Tips

- Light-coloured walls reflect natural light further into rooms
- Skylights are a longer-term investment worth considering

Barriers: Dark rented apartment, Cloudy climate

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.4 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

10. Set your fridge to the right temperature

Difficulty 1 | 5 min | free | global

Check and adjust your fridge temperature to the optimal 3-5°C.

Instructions

- Use a fridge thermometer or the built-in display
- Adjust dial to 3-5°C
- Check freezer is at -18°C

Why it matters: Fridges set too cold use up to 25% more energy, and every degree below -18°C in a freezer costs extra.

Tips

- Most fridges have a dial from 1-7, middle is usually correct
- Keep the fridge at least 3/4 full for efficiency

Barriers: No thermometer, No dial access

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.4 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

11. Install a programmable thermostat

Difficulty 3 | 60 min | low | global

Replace a manual thermostat with a programmable or smart thermostat.

Instructions

- Buy a basic programmable thermostat (\$25-\$50)
- Follow wiring instructions or hire an electrician
- Set programmes: lower when out or asleep, warmer on return

Why it matters: Programmable thermostats reduce heating and cooling bills by an average of 15%.

Tips

- Smart thermostats like Nest learn your schedule automatically
- Check for utility rebates, many are available

Barriers: Renting, Electrical work required

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.4 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

12. Draft-proof your windows and doors

Difficulty 2 | 60 min | low | global

Use draught excluders and self-adhesive foam strips to seal gaps around doors and windows.

Instructions

- Feel for cold air on a windy day around door frames and windows
- Buy self-adhesive foam strip or door snakes
- Apply along all draughty edges

Why it matters: Draughts account for up to 25% of heat loss in older homes. Sealing them is the cheapest insulation upgrade.

Tips

- Self-adhesive foam strip costs under \$5
- A door snake is easily made from old fabric

Barriers: Renting, Brick walls with no obvious gaps

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.4 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

13. Shower with a heating timer

Difficulty 1 | 5 min | free | global

Programme your hot water heater to only run during peak usage times.

Instructions

- Find your hot water timer (usually near the hot water system)
- Set it to run 1 hour before morning showers and 1 hour before evening
- Turn off overnight and midday

Why it matters: Hot water heating is typically 25-30% of a home's energy bill. Timing it right eliminates heating unused water.

Tips

- Heat pump hot water systems are 3× more efficient than electric
- Check for rebates on heat pump HWS installation

Barriers: Renting, Multiple household schedules

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.4 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

14. Turn off lights when leaving a room

Difficulty 1 | 1 min | free | global

Build the habit of switching off every light when you leave a room.

Instructions

- Put a reminder note by the light switch in each room
- Do a full house check before bed each night
- Challenge family members to do the same

Why it matters: Lighting left on in empty rooms wastes an estimated \$100+ per year in the average household.

Tips

- Motion-sensor switches do this automatically
- Smart bulbs can be set to auto-off after 30 minutes

Barriers: Children, Forgetfulness

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.4 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

15. Put on a jumper before heating

Difficulty 1 | 1 min | free | global

When you feel cold, put on an extra layer before turning on the heating.

Instructions

- Add a jumper, socks, or blanket when chilly
- Only turn the heater on if still cold after 5 minutes
- Set heater to no higher than 20°C if used

Why it matters: Each degree of heating adds 8-10% to energy bills. A jumper is free and permanent.

Tips

- Thermal underlayers extend how long you can stay warm
- Hot drinks also effectively warm the body

Barriers: Works less well in very cold climates, Young children who can't regulate temperature

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.4 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

16. Compare energy providers

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | free | global

Look up green energy providers in your area and consider switching.

Instructions

- Get a copy of your last energy bill
- Use a comparison site to find green tariff options
- Switch if a better green deal is available

Why it matters: Switching to a 100% renewable energy tariff eliminates electricity's share of your carbon footprint in one step.

Tips

- Many green tariffs are competitive with standard rates
- Look for providers who invest in new renewable generation, not just certificates

Barriers: Locked into a contract, Limited providers in your area

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.4 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

17. Check your boiler service date

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Check when your boiler or heating system was last serviced and book if overdue.

Instructions

- Find your boiler's last service record
- Book if it's over 12 months ago
- Ask the engineer about efficiency settings at the service

Why it matters: A serviced boiler can be 10-15% more efficient than one that hasn't been maintained.

Tips

- Annual boiler service costs £60-£100 but saves more in efficiency
- Landlords are legally required to service boilers annually

Barriers: Cost of service, Renting, landlord responsibility

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.4 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

18. Close curtains at dusk

Difficulty 1 | 2 min | free | global

Close heavy curtains or blinds as soon as the sun goes down to trap heat.

Instructions

- Set a reminder for dusk
- Close all curtains room by room
- Open them first thing in the morning to catch solar warmth

Why it matters: Heavy curtains reduce heat loss through windows by 15-17%. In cold climates this is significant.

Tips

- Thermal-lined curtains are the most effective
- Even standard curtains closed at dusk make a measurable difference

Barriers: Light sleepers needing blackout curtains open for morning light

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.4 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

19. Microwave or air fryer for small meals

Difficulty 1 | 5 min | free | global

Use the microwave, air fryer, or toaster oven for small portions instead of a full-size oven.

Instructions

- Assess whether the portion you're cooking needs a full oven
- Use the microwave or air fryer for reheating, thawing, and small items
- Use an air fryer or toaster oven for single servings

Why it matters: A microwave or air fryer uses 50-80% less energy than a conventional oven for the same result on small portions.

Tips

- Microwaves cook most things in $\frac{1}{4}$ of the oven time
- Air fryers and toaster ovens preheat in 2-3 minutes vs. 15 for a full oven

Barriers: Preference for oven results, No microwave or air fryer

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.4 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

20. Air dry dishes instead of heated dry

Difficulty 1 | 2 min | free | global

Disable the heated dry cycle on your dishwasher and let dishes air dry.

Instructions

- Find the heated dry or sanitise setting on your dishwasher
- Turn it off or open the door at the end of the wash cycle
- Let dishes air dry overnight

Why it matters: Heated drying adds 15-50% to the dishwasher's energy use while air drying costs nothing.

Tips

- Open the door slightly at the end of the cycle to speed drying
- Dishes are fully sanitary from the hot wash alone

Barriers: Dishes need to be dry before being put away immediately

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.4 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

21. Buy an energy monitor

Difficulty 2 | 20 min | low | global

Plug a smart energy monitor into your fuse box or power outlet to see real-time usage.

Instructions

- Buy a clip-on energy monitor (\$20-\$50)
- Clamp the sensor on your electricity meter cable
- Watch which appliances spike your usage

Why it matters: Homes with energy monitors reduce electricity consumption by 5-15% on average through behavioural change alone.

Tips

- SMETS2 smart meters are free from your utility and show the same data
- Smappee and Sense are popular home energy monitors

Barriers: Cost, Installation complexity

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.4 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

22. Use a laptop instead of a desktop

Difficulty 1 | 5 min | free | global

If you have both a laptop and a desktop, use the laptop for tasks today.

Instructions

- Boot the laptop instead of the desktop
- Keep the desktop off for the day
- Use the laptop plugged in for long sessions

Why it matters: Laptops typically use 5-10× less electricity than desktop computers with monitors.

Tips

- An energy-efficient monitor is the second step if a desktop is needed
- Screens themselves are the largest desktop energy draw

Barriers: Desktop needed for performance tasks

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.4 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

23. Check your hot water temperature

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Reduce your hot water heater temperature to 60°C if it's set higher.

Instructions

- Find your hot water system temperature dial
- Check if it's set above 60°C
- Reduce to 60°C, hot enough for hygiene, no hotter

Why it matters: Every 10°C above 60°C adds approximately 3-5% to water heating bills with no safety benefit.

Tips

- 60°C kills Legionella bacteria, the minimum safe temperature
- Heat pump hot water heaters are 3-4× more efficient than electric resistive

Barriers: Electric tankless, no dial access, Renting

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.4 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

24. Block draughts under your front door

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Roll up a towel or old jumper and place it against the bottom of the front door to stop cold air.

Instructions

- Find a draught near the front or back door
- Roll a towel tightly and place against the base
- Note how much warmer the room feels

Why it matters: A 1cm gap under a door is equivalent to a 12cm hole in the wall in terms of heat loss.

Tips

- Formal draught snakes cost \$5-\$15 and look neater
- Self-adhesive brushes can be fixed permanently to the door base

Barriers: Landlord restrictions on permanent fixes

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.4 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

25. Cook multiple things at once in the oven

Difficulty 1 | 60 min | free | global

When you use the oven, fill it with multiple dishes rather than heating it for one item.

Instructions

- Plan which other dishes can cook at similar temperatures
- Load multiple trays at once
- Batch cook for the week while the oven is on

Why it matters: Preheating an oven uses as much energy as cooking, filling it every time maximises the investment.

Tips

- Most recipes are flexible on temperature by $\pm 20^{\circ}\text{C}$
- Batch roasting vegetables covers lunches for several days

Barriers: Limited oven space, Different cooking times

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.4 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

26. Insulate your hot water tank

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | low | global

Wrap your hot water storage tank in a tank jacket to reduce heat loss.

Instructions

- Buy a hot water cylinder jacket from a hardware store
- Fit it around the cylinder per the instructions
- Check it's covering the whole surface

Why it matters: An uninsulated hot water tank loses heat equivalent to 2 kWh/day, that's 730 kWh/year wasted.

Tips

- Jackets cost \$20-\$30 and pay back in under 3 months
- Pre-insulated tanks already have foam, check yours

Barriers: Combi boiler (no tank), Access to the cylinder

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.4 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

27. Turn off the second fridge

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

If you have a spare fridge or drinks fridge, empty it and turn it off.

Instructions

- Move contents to main fridge if space allows
- Empty the secondary fridge
- Switch it off and leave the door ajar

Why it matters: Old second fridges are often the least efficient appliance in a home, using 300-700 kWh/year.

Tips

- A chest freezer is far more efficient than an upright fridge-freezer
- Only reinstate the second fridge for parties when needed

Barriers: Need the extra storage capacity, High summer heat

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.4 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

28. Read your energy bill carefully

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Read your last energy bill and identify what's driving your highest usage.

Instructions

- Get out your last electricity or gas bill
- Identify which season your usage peaks
- Compare usage per day to your utility's average customer

Why it matters: Understanding your bill is the first step to identifying where to cut, many people have never read one carefully.

Tips

- Most utilities have apps showing daily or hourly usage
- Compare year-on-year to spot trends

Barriers: Bills feel complicated

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

29. Replace your old fridge

Difficulty 3 | 120 min | medium | global

If your fridge is over 10 years old, look into replacing it with an A+++ rated model.

Instructions

- Check the energy rating sticker on your fridge
- Compare the kWh/year figure to current models
- Research options and factor in the total lifecycle including disposal

Why it matters: A 15-year-old fridge uses 2-3× more electricity than a modern equivalent, the replacement pays back in ~5 years.

Tips

- Check for energy efficiency rebates from your utility or government
- Arrange responsible disposal, fridges contain refrigerant gases

Barriers: Upfront cost, Renting

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.4 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

Transport (29)

1. Walk or cycle for a trip under 3km

Difficulty 1 | 30 min | free | global

Replace a short car trip with walking or cycling.

Instructions

- Identify a trip you normally drive that's under 3km
- Walk or cycle it instead
- Note how long it actually takes

Why it matters: 60% of car trips in most cities are under 5km, a distance walkable in under 60 minutes.

Tips

- A cargo bike or e-bike makes it easy with loads
- Google Maps has a cycling time estimate for every route

Barriers: Safety concerns, Hills, Carrying heavy items

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.6 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

2. Take public transport today

Difficulty 1 | 30 min | low | global

Take a bus, train, or tram instead of driving.

Instructions

- Plan the route using a transit app
- Buy a ticket or use your contactless card
- Leave with extra time for the journey

Why it matters: A bus emits 50-80% less CO₂ per passenger than a single-occupancy car. A train emits 80-90% less.

Tips

- Transit apps like Citymapper or Moovit make routing easy
- Monthly passes save money on regular commutes

Barriers: Infrequent service, Journey takes longer, Carrying equipment

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.6 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

3. Work from home today

Difficulty 1 | 5 min | free | global

If your role permits, work from home to avoid a commute.

Instructions

- Arrange remote work with your employer
- Set up a proper workspace at home
- Log your commute distance saved

Why it matters: Working from home one day per week reduces annual commuting emissions by 20%.

Tips

- Use the time saved to exercise or cook from scratch
- Ensure your home workspace is comfortable to avoid bad posture

Barriers: Role requires physical presence, No employer flexibility

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.6 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

4. Carpool with a colleague

Difficulty 2 | 10 min | free | global

Share your drive to work or an appointment with someone going the same direction.

Instructions

- Ask a colleague or neighbour who commutes the same route
- Agree on pickup time and split fuel costs
- Use a carpooling app like BlaBlaCar for longer trips

Why it matters: Filling an otherwise empty car seat halves the per-person emissions of the trip.

Tips

- Waze Carpool and Liftshare connect commuters
- Even one carpool per week adds up to 50 kg CO₂ saved per year

Barriers: Different schedules, Privacy concerns

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.6 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

5. Check tyre pressure

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Check that your car tyres are inflated to the correct pressure.

Instructions

- Find the recommended PSI in your car manual or door sticker
- Check each tyre at a petrol station air pump
- Inflate or deflate to the correct level

Why it matters: Underinflated tyres by just 6 PSI increases fuel consumption by 5% and wears tyres faster.

Tips

- Recommended pressure is on a sticker inside the driver door
- Check monthly, tyres lose ~1 PSI per month naturally

Barriers: No car

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

6. Plan all errands in one trip

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Batch all your errands into a single, efficient trip rather than multiple journeys.

Instructions

- List all errands needed this week
- Plan the most efficient route to do them all in one go
- Do it in one trip

Why it matters: Cold engines use up to 30% more fuel in the first few km, batching trips minimises cold starts.

Tips

- Plan the route to avoid backtracking
- Click and collect can combine multiple shopping into one trip

Barriers: Time constraints across the week

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.6 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

7. Drive at the speed limit on the motorway

Difficulty 1 | 1 min | free | global

Drive at or slightly below the speed limit on your next motorway journey.

Instructions

- Set cruise control to the speed limit if available
- Avoid overtaking unnecessarily
- Leave earlier to reduce urgency

Why it matters: Driving at 110 km/h vs. 130 km/h uses 25% less fuel, aerodynamic drag rises as the square of speed.

Tips

- Cruise control maintains the most fuel-efficient speed
- Drafting trucks saves fuel but keep a safe distance

Barriers: Time pressure, Other drivers' expectations

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.6 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

8. Try an e-bike for a commute

Difficulty 2 | 60 min | low | global

Borrow or hire an e-bike and test it for your work commute.

Instructions

- Find an e-bike hire service or borrow from a friend
- Map your commute route with cycling navigation
- Ride it in and back and note total time vs. driving

Why it matters: An e-bike uses ~0.01 kWh/km, 50× less energy than an average car. It's also faster than driving in cities.

Tips

- Many cities have docked or dockless e-bike hire
- E-bike commuters arrive less sweaty than expected

Barriers: Safety on roads, No safe storage at work

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.6 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

9. Avoid flying short haul

Difficulty 3 | 60 min | low | global

For any trip under 3 hours by plane, investigate train or coach as an alternative.

Instructions

- Look up your next planned flight destination
- Check train/coach time and cost
- Book if it's viable, even if slightly longer

Why it matters: A return short-haul flight produces 0.5-1.5 tonnes of CO₂ equivalent, equal to 2-3 months of driving.

Tips

- Night trains eliminate hotel costs and travel simultaneously
- Rail is often faster city-centre to city-centre when check-in is factored

Barriers: Speed, Cost in some markets, International routes with no rail

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.6 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

10. Walk the school run

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | free | global

Walk your children to school instead of driving.

Instructions

- Check the walking route is safe
- Leave 20 minutes earlier than usual
- Make it enjoyable, spot wildlife, count things

Why it matters: The school run accounts for 20% of urban morning traffic in many cities.

Tips

- Walking buses connect multiple families on one route
- Children who walk to school perform better in morning classes

Barriers: Distance too far, Weather, Early start timing

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.6 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

11. Offset your last flight

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | low | global

Calculate the emissions from your last flight and purchase a high-quality carbon offset.

Instructions

- Use ICAO carbon calculator for your flights
- Choose a Gold Standard or Verra-certified offset
- Purchase and keep the certificate

Why it matters: While not a substitute for flying less, high-quality offsets fund real-world emission reductions.

Tips

- Gold Standard offsets cost \$8-\$20 per tonne of CO₂
- Atmosfair and South Pole offer independently verified offsets

Barriers: Scepticism about offset quality, valid, so choose carefully

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.6 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

12. Ditch the car for a day

Difficulty 2 | 10 min | free | global

Go the entire day without using a private car, walk, cycle, or take transit for everything.

Instructions

- Plan your day the night before without a car
- Identify which trips can be walked, cycled, or transited
- Log how many kg CO₂ you avoided

Why it matters: The average car journey produces 0.18 kg CO₂/km, going car-free for one day saves 3-6 kg.

Tips

- Tell someone you're doing it for accountability
- Try it on a weekend first when trips are discretionary

Barriers: Kids' activities, Remote location, Disability

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.6 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

13. Use train instead of car for a long trip

Difficulty 2 | 120 min | low | global

Choose the train for your next journey over 100km.

Instructions

- Book train tickets early, prices drop significantly
- Account for the city-centre to city-centre time advantage
- Use travel time productively

Why it matters: Train travel emits 80-90% less CO₂ per km than car travel. On electric rail it can be near-zero.

Tips

- Book 8-12 weeks ahead for best prices
- Railcards offer 1/3 off in the UK for regular travellers

Barriers: Cost, No service to destination, Carrying luggage

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.6 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

14. Research electric vehicle options

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | free | global

Look into EV models suited to your needs and budget, including second-hand options.

Instructions

- List your typical daily driving distance
- Search for EVs with enough range for your needs
- Use a total cost calculator including fuel and maintenance savings

Why it matters: Over its lifetime, an EV produces 50-70% less CO₂ than a petrol car even on average grid electricity.

Tips

- Used EVs (2020+) are increasingly affordable
- Government purchase incentives and grants are available in many countries

Barriers: Upfront cost, Charging infrastructure concerns

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

15. Cancel a non-essential flight

Difficulty 3 | 20 min | free | global

Review upcoming travel plans and cancel or replace any non-essential flight.

Instructions

- List your upcoming flights
- Assess which are truly necessary
- For one non-essential flight, explore alternatives or cancellation

Why it matters: One long-haul return flight can exceed an individual's entire sustainable annual carbon budget.

Tips

- Virtual meetings have improved dramatically since 2020
- Conference organisers increasingly offer hybrid attendance options

Barriers: Work requirements, Family commitments, Non-refundable tickets

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.6 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

16. Get a bicycle service

Difficulty 2 | 60 min | low | global

Take your bicycle to a mechanic for a service to make it ride-ready.

Instructions

- Book into a local bike shop for a basic service
- Get brakes, gears, and tyres checked
- Ask about anything that's been bothering you about the ride

Why it matters: A well-maintained bike is safer, more enjoyable, and more likely to be used instead of a car.

Tips

- Basic services cost \$30-\$60 and transform the ride quality
- Many councils run free bike fixing clinics

Barriers: Don't own a bike, Cost

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.6 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

17. Walk to a local shop instead of driving

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Walk to a nearby shop for your next small purchase instead of driving.

Instructions

- Identify your nearest shop for the items you need
- Walk instead of taking the car
- Bring a reusable bag

Why it matters: Short car trips are disproportionately polluting, cold engines in the first few minutes run at peak inefficiency.

Tips

- Note your mood after walking vs. driving, most people feel better
- Carry a folding bag in your pocket at all times

Barriers: Distance too far, Carrying heavy items, Disability

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.6 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

18. Learn to ride a bike

Difficulty 3 | 60 min | low | global

Take a beginner cycling lesson or practise riding in a safe area.

Instructions

- Find a quiet car park or park to practise
 - Use a Bikeability or community cycling course
 - Start with balance on a lowered seat with no pedals
- Why it matters:** 1 in 3 UK adults can't cycle confidently, free learn-to-ride courses exist in most cities.

Tips

- Adult learn-to-ride courses are run by councils for free
- E-bikes reduce the fitness barrier significantly

Barriers: Confidence, Fear of traffic, Physical limitations

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

19. Switch to a smaller or more efficient car

Difficulty 3 | 120 min | medium | global

Research downsizing to a more fuel-efficient vehicle on your next car purchase.

Instructions

- Note your current car's fuel consumption (L/100km)
- Research hybrids or efficient petrol alternatives in your class
- Calculate annual fuel savings at your mileage

Why it matters: Moving from 10 L/100km to 6 L/100km saves over 1 tonne of CO₂ per 15,000 km driven.

Tips

- Hybrid SUVs are now comparable in price to standard ones
- Leased hybrids sometimes cost less per month than older owned petrol cars

Barriers: Upfront cost, Already have a newer car

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.6 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

20. Try a trial month of no car

Difficulty 3 | 30 min | free | global

Commit to a month without using your private car.

Instructions

- Inform household members of the challenge
- Plan the month using transit, cycling, and walking
- Track total CO₂ and money saved

Why it matters: The average car sits unused 95% of the time. A trial month shows whether it's truly necessary.

Tips

- Car clubs and rental are available for genuine car-needed trips
- Many families realise they can permanently reduce to one car

Barriers: Remote location, Disability, Family with young children

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.6 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

21. Avoid idling your engine

Difficulty 1 | 1 min | free | global

Turn off your engine whenever you're stationary for more than 30 seconds.

Instructions

- When parked and waiting, switch the engine off
- Avoid idling to warm up in the morning, modern engines don't need it
- Turn off immediately when parked

Why it matters: Idling for 10 minutes uses as much fuel as driving 8 km.

Tips

- Modern engines are ready to drive immediately after starting
- Many countries have anti-idling laws in school zones

Barriers: Air conditioning need in hot climates, Habit

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.6 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

22. Use eco mode in your car

Difficulty 1 | 2 min | free | global

Enable the eco or efficiency mode in your car's settings.

Instructions

- Find the eco/efficiency button or drive mode selector
- Switch to eco mode before starting
- Drive normally, the car will optimise automatically

Why it matters: Eco mode reduces throttle response and optimises gear changes, cutting fuel use by 5-15%.

Tips

- Eco mode works best at steady speeds, less so in heavy traffic
- Some cars show live fuel efficiency in eco mode

Barriers: No eco mode in older cars

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.6 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

23. Reduce car air conditioning use

Difficulty 1 | 2 min | free | global

Use the car's ventilation rather than air conditioning at lower speeds.

Instructions

- At speeds under 60 km/h, open windows instead of using A/C
- On highways, use A/C at a higher temp setting to reduce compressor load
- Park in shade to reduce the need to pre-cool

Why it matters: Air conditioning increases fuel consumption by 5-25% depending on conditions and vehicle size.

Tips

- Sunshades on parked windscreens reduce interior temperature by 10-15°C
- Cool the car for 2 minutes before leaving rather than running A/C all the way

Barriers: Extreme heat

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.6 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

24. Donate your car to charity

Difficulty 3 | 60 min | free | global

If you rarely use your car, investigate donating or selling it.

Instructions

- Track how many days per week you use the car
- If less than 3, explore car club or car-share alternatives
- Research charities or resale options

Why it matters: Car-free households produce 2-3 tonnes less CO₂ per year than car-owning equivalents, plus save \$3,000-\$10,000.

Tips

- Car clubs give access to a car when needed without ownership costs
- Public transit passes often cost a fraction of car ownership

Barriers: Rural area, Disability, Family obligations

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

25. Check public transit for a new route

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Look up the public transit options for a regular journey you make by car.

Instructions

- Open a transit app or Google Maps in transit mode
- Enter your regular route
- Note the time difference and cost compared to driving

Why it matters: Most people overestimate how much longer transit takes, especially when you factor in parking.

Tips

- Commuting by transit allows reading, podcasts, or napping
- Weekly transit passes cost less than daily parking in most city centres

Barriers: Infrequent services, Last-mile problem

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.6 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

26. Download a carbon tracking app

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Install a personal carbon tracking app and log your transport for a week.

Instructions

- Download Oroeco, Capture, or a similar app
- Log your trips for 7 days
- Review which trips produce the most emissions

Why it matters: People who track their carbon footprint reduce it 10-20% within 3 months through small behaviour shifts.

Tips

- Many banking apps now include carbon tracking (Monzo, Starling)
- Wren and Terrapass offer integrated tracking and offsets

Barriers: Privacy concerns, Data entry fatigue

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.6 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

27. Use a cargo bike for grocery shopping

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | low | global

Hire or borrow a cargo bike and do your weekly shop by bicycle.

Instructions

- Find a cargo bike hire service or a friend with one
- Plan the shop around what fits in the box
- Ride to the supermarket and back

Why it matters: Cargo bikes can carry 100+ kg, most families' weekly shop fits easily.

Tips

- E-cargo bikes make steep hills and heavier loads simple
- Many cities now offer subsidised cargo bike hire

Barriers: Hills, Distance, Cost of owning

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.6 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

28. Walk a meeting

Difficulty 1 | 30 min | free | global

Take your next one-on-one meeting as a walking meeting outdoors.

Instructions

- Suggest a walk-and-talk to your meeting partner
- Choose a quiet route
- Walk while discussing (use earbuds if on a call)

Why it matters: Walking meetings increase creativity by 81% according to Stanford research, and eliminate a sedentary hour.

Tips

- Walking meetings work best for brainstorming and 1:1 catch-ups
- Record key points on a voice memo as you walk

Barriers: Formal meetings requiring notes, Bad weather

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.6 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

29. Plan a staycation

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | low | global

Plan a local holiday or weekend break that doesn't involve flying.

Instructions

- Research destinations within train or bus distance
- Plan 3 days of activities as you would for a foreign trip
- Book accommodation and transport locally

Why it matters: Swapping a return flight for a train-based UK or European holiday saves 0.5-2 tonnes of CO₂.

Tips

- Interrailing, slow travel, and canal boating are popular alternatives
- Local areas are often unexplored and cheaper than foreign destinations

Barriers: Preference for foreign travel, Work leave constraints

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.6 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

Waste (29)

1. Do a rubbish audit

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Sort through your bin before putting it out and identify what could have been recycled, composted, or avoided.

Instructions

- Empty your general waste bin onto a sheet
- Sort into: recyclable, compostable, genuine waste
- Note the top 3 items you'll try to eliminate

Why it matters: Most household rubbish bins contain 60-80% material that could be composted or recycled.

Tips

- A bin audit takes 10 minutes and changes behaviour instantly
- Take a photo to track improvement month by month

Barriers: Unpleasant task, Large household volume

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

2. Refuse a plastic bag

Difficulty 1 | 1 min | free | global

Decline a plastic bag at checkout and use a bag you already have.

Instructions

- Keep a reusable bag in your coat pocket or car
- Say no to a plastic bag at the register
- If caught without one, carry items by hand or in a cardboard box

Why it matters: A plastic bag is used for an average of 12 minutes but takes 500 years to break down.

Tips

- Fold a tote bag flat and keep it in your pocket
- String bags compress to almost nothing

Barriers: Forgetting the bag

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.3 kg

3. Recycle correctly today

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Look up your council's recycling rules and ensure everything in your bin is correctly sorted.

Instructions

- Search "[your council] what can I recycle"
- Check your recycling bin for common contaminants
- Remove anything that shouldn't be there

Why it matters: Contamination from wishful recycling ruins entire loads, one greasy pizza box can contaminate a tonne of paper.

Tips

- When in doubt, throw it out rather than contaminate the batch
- Soft plastics go to supermarket drop-offs, not kerbside

Barriers: Rules differ by council and are confusing

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.3 kg

4. Switch to a reusable coffee cup

Difficulty 1 | 5 min | low | global

Bring a reusable cup to your coffee shop today.

Instructions

- Grab a reusable cup before you leave home
- Ask the barista to use it
- Wash it at the end of the day

Why it matters: Takeaway coffee cups have a plastic lining that makes them non-recyclable, 2.5 billion go to landfill in the UK each year.

Tips

- Most cafés offer a 10-30p discount for your own cup
- KeepCup and Fellow are the most popular options

Barriers: Forgetting the cup

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.3 kg

5. Repair instead of replace

Difficulty 2 | 60 min | low | global

Fix one broken item at home rather than throwing it away.

Instructions

- Identify one broken item around the house
- Watch a YouTube tutorial for the repair
- Fix it with basic tools or take it to a repair café

Why it matters: Manufacturing a new product produces 10-20× more carbon than repairing the old one.

Tips

- iFixit.com has step-by-step guides for thousands of items
- Community repair cafés offer free tools and expertise

Barriers: Skills, Spare parts availability

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.3 kg

6. Go paperless on bills

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Switch all utility and bank bills to electronic delivery.

Instructions

- Log into your utility, bank, and insurance accounts
- Enable paperless billing in settings
- Set up a folder in your email for digital statements

Why it matters: The average household receives 40+ paper bills per year. Digital billing eliminates envelopes, ink, and transport.

Tips

- Use a password manager to remember account logins
- Most companies have paperless billing under account settings

Barriers: Older family members who prefer paper, Not tech-confident

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.3 kg

7. Bring your own container to a takeaway

Difficulty 2 | 5 min | free | global

Bring a clean container from home and ask your local takeaway to use it.

Instructions

- Bring a suitable container when collecting takeaway
- Ask if the restaurant will fill it instead of their packaging
- Most will say yes if asked nicely

Why it matters: A single takeaway meal can generate 200-300g of single-use packaging waste.

Tips

- Pyrex or stainless steel containers are ideal
 - Call ahead to give the shop notice
- Barriers:** Awkwardness of asking, Health regulations in some venues

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.3 kg

8. Use cloth rags instead of paper towels

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Cut up an old T-shirt or use cloth rags for kitchen cleaning instead of paper towels.

Instructions

- Cut an old T-shirt into 20cm squares
- Keep them in a basket near the sink
- Wash with laundry and reuse indefinitely

Why it matters: The average household uses 50+ rolls of paper towels per year, cloth rags eliminate this entirely.

Tips

- Microfibre cloths clean better than paper towels for most tasks
- Use a separate basket for soiled rags, just throw them in the wash

Barriers: Perceived hygiene concerns

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.3 kg

9. Find your local recycling drop-offs

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Map out the nearest drop-off points for soft plastics, batteries, and e-waste.

Instructions

- Search "soft plastic recycling near me"
- Find your nearest battery collection point (usually supermarkets)
- Find the nearest e-waste facility

Why it matters: Batteries contain toxic heavy metals; e-waste contains recoverable gold, silver, and copper, all wasted in landfill.

Tips

- REDcycle at Coles and Woolworths takes soft plastics in Australia
- Call2Recycle handles batteries in the US and Canada

Barriers: Distance to drop-off points

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.3 kg

10. Swap cling wrap for beeswax wraps

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | low | global

Replace single-use cling wrap with reusable beeswax food wraps.

Instructions

- Buy a set of beeswax wraps
- Use to cover bowls and wrap sandwiches
- Wash with cool water and soap and reuse

Why it matters: Cling wrap cannot be recycled and persists in oceans for hundreds of years. Beeswax wraps last 1-2 years.

Tips

- Use your hands' warmth to mould them around bowls
- Don't use with raw meat, keep for veg and cooked food

Barriers: Cost upfront, Not suitable for raw meat

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.3 kg

11. Recycle old electronics

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | free | global

Find and drop off at least one old phone, cable, or appliance at an e-waste recycling point.

Instructions

- Check drawers for old phones, chargers, or small appliances
- Wipe personal data from phones
- Drop at a manufacturer store, council facility, or e-waste event

Why it matters: E-waste is the fastest-growing waste stream globally, only 17% is recycled. It contains rare earth metals worth \$57B per year.

Tips

- Apple, Samsung, and most retailers take back old devices
- eBay and Swappa are good for resale before recycling

Barriers: Data security concerns, Distance to drop-off

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.3 kg

12. Cancel junk mail

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Register to stop unaddressed junk mail being delivered to your home.

Instructions

- Put a "No Junk Mail" sticker on your letterbox
- Register with your national mail opt-out service
- Unsubscribe from catalogues you receive addressed mail from

Why it matters: The average household receives 18kg of junk mail per year, nearly all goes straight to recycling or landfill.

Tips

- DMA Mail Preference Service covers most UK addressed direct mail
- A simple sign on the letterbox stops most leaflets

Barriers: Some mail is unavoidable

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.3 kg

13. Compost with worms

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | low | global

Set up a small worm farm for your kitchen scraps.

Instructions

- Buy a worm farm kit or make one from two stacked tubs
- Add tiger worms (order online or from garden centres)
- Feed kitchen scraps in small amounts daily

Why it matters: Worm castings (vermicompost) are one of the richest soil amendments, better than most commercial compost.

Tips

- Start small, a single bedding tray processes a household's scraps
- Worm farms thrive indoors in apartments

Barriers: Worm aversion, Initial setup cost ~\$50

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.5 kg

14. Buy second-hand today

Difficulty 1 | 30 min | low | global

Find something you need second-hand rather than buying new.

Instructions

- Think of something you've been meaning to buy
- Check Facebook Marketplace, Gumtree, eBay, or a charity shop first
- Only buy new if second-hand isn't available

Why it matters: Manufacturing a new item uses 5-80× more energy than giving an existing one a second life.

Tips

- Vinted and Depop are excellent for clothes
- Facebook Marketplace is best for furniture and appliances

Barriers: Condition uncertainty, Availability of specific items

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.3 kg

15. Host a clothes swap

Difficulty 2 | 120 min | free | global

Organise a clothes swap with friends, bring items you don't wear, take things you'll use.

Instructions

- Invite 5-10 friends and ask each to bring 5 items
- Set up a browsing area and allow everyone to pick
- Donate unclaimed items to charity

Why it matters: Fashion is responsible for 10% of global CO₂ emissions. Clothes swaps extend garment life with zero production impact.

Tips

- Include accessories, books, and household items too
- Make it social, food and drinks make it an event

Barriers: Different sizes, Organising group schedules

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

16. Use a reusable water bottle

Difficulty 1 | 2 min | low | global

Switch from single-use water bottles to a reusable one for all drinks today.

Instructions

- Fill a reusable bottle at home
- Carry it everywhere
- Refill at taps, fountains, or cafés

Why it matters: One million plastic bottles are purchased every minute globally. Most are not recycled.

Tips

- The Refill app shows every free water refill point near you
- Stainless steel keeps drinks cold for 24 hours

Barriers: Forgetting to bring it

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.3 kg

17. Avoid single-use cutlery

Difficulty 1 | 5 min | free | global

Carry a set of reusable cutlery for meals on the go.

Instructions

- Pack a fork, knife, and spoon in a small pouch in your bag
- Decline plastic cutlery at takeaways
- Wash at home and repack

Why it matters: 40 billion single-use plastic utensils are used in the US each year, almost none of which is recycled.

Tips

- Bamboo travel cutlery sets are lightweight and cheap
- A single real fork weighs almost nothing in a bag

Barriers: Forgetting to pack it

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.3 kg

18. Make DIY cleaning products

Difficulty 2 | 20 min | free | global

Make an all-purpose cleaner from vinegar, water, and essential oils instead of buying a plastic-bottled one.

Instructions

- Mix 1 part white vinegar with 1 part water in a spray bottle
- Add 10 drops of tea tree or lemon essential oil
- Use on benches, sinks, and surfaces

Why it matters: DIY cleaners eliminate plastic bottles and toxic chemicals at 90% lower cost than commercial products.

Tips

- White vinegar is effective against most household bacteria
- Baking soda + vinegar paste cleans grout and tiles

Barriers: Dislike of vinegar smell (fades quickly)

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.3 kg

19. Take food scraps to a community compost

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Find a community compost site and drop off your week's kitchen scraps.

Instructions

- Search "community compost near me" or check ShareWaste.com
- Collect scraps in a sealed container all week
- Drop them off at the collection point

Why it matters: ShareWaste connects people who have scraps with neighbours who have compost bins or chickens.

Tips

- Most community gardens accept kitchen scraps
- ShareWaste.com maps thousands of collection points globally

Barriers: Distance to collection, No car for bulk transport

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.5 kg

20. Reduce bathroom waste

Difficulty 2 | 20 min | low | global

Switch one bathroom product to a zero-waste alternative today.

Instructions

- Choose one product: shampoo, conditioner, soap, or deodorant
- Find the solid bar or refillable equivalent
- Use up your current stock then switch

Why it matters: The average person uses 11 personal care products per day, generating enormous plastic waste. Solid bars eliminate most of it.

Tips

- Shampoo bars from Lush or similar last 2-3× longer than bottled shampoo
- Bamboo toothbrushes are the simplest first swap

Barriers: Adjustment period for hair with shampoo bars, Cost of premium alternatives

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.3 kg

21. Refuse a straw

Difficulty 1 | 1 min | free | global

Ask for no straw with your next drink.

Instructions

- When ordering, say "no straw please"
- If a straw arrives by default, return it unused
- Carry a reusable metal or bamboo straw if you need one

Why it matters: 8.3 billion straws pollute the world's beaches. They're one of the top 10 items found in ocean cleanups.

Tips

- Paper straws are widely available as a fallback
- Metal and glass straws last indefinitely

Barriers: Some drinks benefit from a straw, Accessibility needs for some people

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.3 kg

22. Donate clothes you haven't worn in a year

Difficulty 2 | 60 min | free | global

Sort your wardrobe and donate anything unworn in the past 12 months.

Instructions

- Go through every item in your wardrobe
- Set aside anything not worn in 12+ months
- Bag for charity shop, clothes bank, or resale

Why it matters: The average garment is worn 7 times before disposal. Donating adds 5+ more uses and keeps it from landfill.

Tips

- Vinted and Depop earn money from clothes resale
- Charity shops specifically need good-condition everyday clothing

Barriers: Emotional attachment to items, Time to sort

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

23. Switch to a safety razor

Difficulty 2 | 10 min | low | global

Replace a disposable plastic razor with a metal safety razor.

Instructions

- Buy a safety razor (£10-£25)
- Buy a pack of replacement blades (~\$5 for 50)
- Learn the angle technique, shave with minimal pressure

Why it matters: 2 billion disposable razors are thrown away in the US alone each year. A safety razor lasts decades.

Tips

- Start slowly, safety razors are sharper than disposables
- Blades can be recycled at most metal recyclers

Barriers: Learning curve, Upfront cost

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.3 kg

24. Opt out of hotel toiletry mini bottles

Difficulty 1 | 2 min | free | global

When staying at a hotel, bring your own toiletries and decline the mini plastic bottles.

Instructions

- Pack travel-sized versions of your own products
- Inform the hotel you don't need toiletries restocked
- Leave the mini bottles sealed for the next guest if there

Why it matters: US hotels alone generate 200 million mini toiletry bottles per year.

Tips

- Many eco-hotels now have refillable dispensers
- Solid toiletry bars are perfectly travel-sized

Barriers: Already packed toiletries not available

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.3 kg

25. Recycle cooking oil

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Pour used cooking oil into a sealed container and find a local recycling point.

Instructions

- Cool used oil completely
- Pour into a sealed bottle or jar
- Find your nearest cooking oil recycling facility (many councils and supermarkets)

Why it matters: Cooking oil poured down drains causes fatbergs, the congealed masses that block sewers. Recycled oil becomes biodiesel.

Tips

- Many councils have cooking oil recycling in their waste centres
- Chip shops and restaurants are required to recycle commercially

Barriers: Finding the collection point

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.3 kg

26. Eliminate single-use batteries

Difficulty 2 | 20 min | low | global

Replace any device using single-use batteries with rechargeable batteries.

Instructions

- Identify devices in your home using AA or AAA batteries
- Buy a set of rechargeable NiMH batteries and a charger
- Swap them in and recycle the disposable batteries

Why it matters: A single rechargeable battery replaces 1,000+ disposable batteries over its lifespan.

Tips

- Eneloop batteries by Panasonic are the gold standard
- Rechargeable batteries are cheaper per use within weeks

Barriers: Upfront cost of batteries and charger (~\$30)

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.3 kg

27. Use library instead of buying books

Difficulty 1 | 30 min | free | global

Borrow a book from the library rather than buying a new one.

Instructions

- Find your nearest library or online library portal
- Search for a book you want to read
- Borrow it for free

Why it matters: Producing a single book emits ~1 kg CO₂ and uses 10 litres of water. Libraries share that cost across hundreds of readers.

Tips

- Many libraries offer digital loans through Libby or BorrowBox, no travel needed
- Open Library offers free digital access to millions of books

Barriers: Convenience of online shopping, Specific titles not in stock

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.3 kg

28. Set up a recycling station

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | low | global

Create clearly labelled bins for recycling, compost, and general waste.

Instructions

- Buy or repurpose 3 containers
- Label them clearly: Recycling / Compost / Landfill
- Place them side by side in the kitchen and brief household members

Why it matters: Households with organised sorting systems divert 40% more material from landfill than those without.

Tips

- Small counter caddy for compost reduces trips outside
- Colour-code lids to match your council's bins

Barriers: Kitchen space, Other household members not cooperating

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.3 kg

29. Return soft plastics to supermarket

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Collect your soft plastic packaging (bread bags, bubble wrap, chip packets) and drop them at a supermarket collection point.

Instructions

- Collect soft plastics in a bag for a week
- Check if your supermarket has a soft plastic collection bin
- Drop them off on your next shopping trip

Why it matters: Soft plastics are accepted by REDcycle (Australia), Terracycle drop-offs (UK/US), and major supermarket chains in many countries.

Tips

- Everything stretchy goes in: bread bags, pasta bags, chip packets, bubble wrap
- One bag per month is a typical household volume

Barriers: Not all supermarkets have collection, Not available in all countries

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.3 kg

Consumption (28)

1. Spend nothing today

Difficulty 2 | 5 min | free | global

Go the entire day without spending money on anything non-essential.

Instructions

- Plan meals from what you already have
- Avoid browsing online shops
- Use what you own for entertainment and meals

Why it matters: No-spend days reduce impulse purchases by 30% in people who practise them weekly.

Tips

- Delete shopping apps from your phone for the day
- Announce it to a friend for accountability

Barriers: Social commitments, Habitual daily spending

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.8 kg | Water 20 L | Waste 0.2 kg

2. Unsubscribe from marketing emails

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Unsubscribe from at least 10 retail marketing emails to reduce impulse buying triggers.

Instructions

- Go through your inbox and identify promotional emails
- Click "unsubscribe" on each one
- Use Unroll.me or similar to bulk unsubscribe

Why it matters: Marketing emails are the #1 driver of unplanned purchases, removing them reduces spending by an average of 15%.

Tips

- Unroll.me shows all your subscriptions and lets you cancel in bulk
- Create a dedicated email for shops to keep your main inbox clean

Barriers: Useful occasional newsletters mixed in

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.8 kg | Water 20 L | Waste 0.2 kg

3. Borrow instead of buy

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Before buying something, check if you can borrow it from a neighbour, friend, or library.

Instructions

- Think of something you need but don't use often
- Ask a neighbour, friend, or family member if they have one
- Return it in better condition than you received it

Why it matters: The average power drill is used for 12 minutes in its lifetime. Sharing tools eliminates the need for mass individual ownership.

Tips

- Tool libraries and community sheds offer hundreds of tools for borrowing
- Nextdoor and neighbourhood Facebook groups are great for one-off borrows

Barriers: Not knowing who to ask, Not wanting to impose

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.8 kg | Water 20 L | Waste 0.2 kg

4. Try a no-new-clothes month

Difficulty 3 | 5 min | free | global

Commit to buying no new clothing for 30 days.

Instructions

- Make a visible note of the commitment
- When tempted, style an existing item differently instead
- Track the money you're saving

Why it matters: The fashion industry emits 1.2 billion tonnes of CO₂ per year, more than aviation and maritime shipping combined.

Tips

- The Outfit Repeater app helps you get creative with what you own
- If you genuinely need an item, shop second-hand only

Barriers: Specific need arising, Events requiring new outfits

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.8 kg | Water 20 L | Waste 0.2 kg

5. Research before a big purchase

Difficulty 1 | 30 min | free | global

Before any purchase over \$50, wait 48 hours and research the sustainability of the brand.

Instructions

- Add the item to a wishlist instead of buying immediately
- Research the brand's environmental and ethical credentials
- After 48 hours, decide if you still need it and if the brand is acceptable

Why it matters: A 48-hour pause eliminates 70% of impulse purchases and dramatically reduces buyer's remorse.

Tips

- Good On You app rates fashion brands on sustainability
- Check Brand Rating and B Corp certification for other products

Barriers: Time-sensitive sales, Genuine urgent need

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

6. Declutter one drawer

Difficulty 1 | 30 min | free | global

Sort one junk drawer or cupboard, keep what you use, donate the rest.

Instructions

- Pick one drawer or box
- Remove everything and sort into: keep, donate, recycle, bin
- Rehouse or donate within the week

Why it matters: Decluttering increases awareness of what you already own, reducing duplicate purchases by an average of 20%.

Tips

- The "have I used it in the past year?" rule is reliable
- Take a photo of sentimental items before donating, the memory is enough

Barriers: Attachment to objects, Time to complete

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.8 kg | Water 20 L | Waste 0.2 kg

7. Choose a B Corp brand

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | low | global

Find and buy from a B Corp-certified company for something you were going to buy anyway.

Instructions

- Go to [bcorporation.net](https://www.bcorporation.net) and search for brands in your category
- Find a B Corp alternative to your usual brand
- Buy from them and share why on social media

Why it matters: B Corp companies meet rigorous environmental and social standards verified by independent auditors.

Tips

- Patagonia, Ben & Jerry's, and The Body Shop are well-known B Corps
- The B Corp directory covers thousands of brands by category

Barriers: Higher price point in some categories, Not all categories have B Corp options

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.8 kg | Water 20 L | Waste 0.2 kg

8. Rent your clothes for an event

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | low | global

For an upcoming formal event, rent an outfit rather than buying a new one.

Instructions

- Find a formal wear rental service
- Rent for the event period
- Return clean, most services handle dry cleaning

Why it matters: A rented outfit has 1/10 the carbon footprint of buying new, and is worn for the full intended purpose.

Tips

- Rent the Runway (US) and By Rotation (UK) are major platforms
- Wedding outfits especially benefit from rental, worn once, enormous waste otherwise

Barriers: Sizing accuracy online, Availability

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.8 kg | Water 20 L | Waste 0.2 kg

9. Check your subscriptions

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Review all monthly subscriptions and cancel any you don't actively use.

Instructions

- Check your bank statements for recurring charges
- List every subscription
- Cancel any used less than once a week

Why it matters: The average person pays for 3-4 subscriptions they don't use regularly, a direct cost of \$50-\$200/month.

Tips

- Rocket Money and Trim apps find forgotten subscriptions automatically
- Annual subscriptions often hide in statements as a single charge

Barriers: Fear of losing access, Cancellation process being complex

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.8 kg | Water 20 L | Waste 0.2 kg

10. Make your own gifts

Difficulty 2 | 60 min | low | global

For an upcoming occasion, make a gift instead of buying one.

Instructions

- Choose an upcoming birthday or event
- Select a handmade option: baked goods, homemade jam, a written card, a voucher for your time
- Prepare with care and present thoughtfully

Why it matters: Gift-giving generates 5.8 billion kg of waste in the US each November-January alone. Handmade gifts produce near zero.

Tips

- Consumable gifts (food, experiences) create no lasting waste
- A "gift of time", cooking dinner, a massage, a day out, is often the most valued

Barriers: Skills, Time to prepare

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.8 kg | Water 20 L | Waste 0.2 kg

11. Buy nothing for a day (challenge mode)

Difficulty 3 | 5 min | free | global

Join the global Buy Nothing Day and make zero purchases.

Instructions

- Plan the day the night before, meals from pantry, activities that cost nothing
- Delete shopping apps temporarily
- Note what you almost bought and why

Why it matters: Buy Nothing Day (usually the day after US Thanksgiving) is celebrated globally as a conscious break from consumption culture.

Tips

- The feelings of urge to buy are data, write them down
- Replace the urge with a walk, call a friend, or cook something

Barriers: Genuine essential needs, Social events that require spending

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.8 kg | Water 20 L | Waste 0.2 kg

12. Switch to a sustainable bank

Difficulty 3 | 60 min | free | global

Research and switch to a bank that doesn't invest in fossil fuels.

Instructions

- Check if your bank funds fossil fuels at BankTrack.org
- Research ethical alternatives in your country
- Open an account and transfer within 30 days

Why it matters: The 60 largest banks have provided \$5.5 trillion to fossil fuel companies since 2015. Moving your money is one of the highest-impact individual actions.

Tips

- Triodos, Monzo (UK), and Amalgamated Bank (US) are fossil-fuel-free options
- You don't have to close the old account immediately, test the new one first

Barriers: Time to switch, Concern about coverage and features

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.8 kg | Water 20 L | Waste 0.2 kg

13. Read one article on fast fashion

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Read about the environmental and human cost of fast fashion and reflect on your shopping habits.

Instructions

- Search "fast fashion environmental impact" or "garment workers rights"
- Read one long-form article
- Note one thing that surprised you

Why it matters: Fashion production uses 93 billion cubic metres of water per year, enough to supply 5 million people.

Tips

- The True Cost is a documentary on Netflix covering the full picture
- Fashion Checker rates brands on supply chain transparency

Barriers: Overwhelming to read about

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

14. Repair your shoes

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | low | global

Take a pair of worn shoes to a cobbler rather than discarding them.

Instructions

- Find a local cobbler or shoe repair shop
- Take your most worn pair for assessment
- Get new soles, heels, or polishing done

Why it matters: Shoe production uses leather tanning chemicals and enormous water, a cobbler extends life for a fraction of the environmental cost.

Tips

- Most shoes worth \$80+ can be resolved for \$20-\$40
- Regular polishing and sole protectors massively extend shoe life before repair is needed

Barriers: Cost relative to cheap replacement shoes, Finding a local cobbler

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.8 kg | Water 20 L | Waste 0.2 kg

15. Track your spending for a week

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Log every purchase you make for 7 days to identify your unnecessary spending patterns.

Instructions

- Create a simple spreadsheet or use a notes app
- Log every purchase, however small
- Categorise at the end of the week

Why it matters: People who track spending reduce consumption by 15% on average, awareness alone changes behaviour.

Tips

- YNAB and Emma are great apps for automatic tracking
- Even manual tracking for one week builds lasting awareness

Barriers: Forgetting to log in the moment, Feeling judged by the data

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.8 kg | Water 20 L | Waste 0.2 kg

16. Gift an experience, not a thing

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | low | global

Buy an experience gift (concert tickets, cooking class, spa day) instead of a physical object.

Instructions

- Think of an upcoming occasion requiring a gift
- Research experience options suited to the recipient
- Purchase or create a voucher for the experience

Why it matters: Experiences produce negligible waste compared to physical goods, and studies show experiences make people happier than things.

Tips

- Free experiences, a picnic, a walk, a homemade dinner, are often the most valued
- National Trust memberships, cooking classes, and spa days are popular gift experiences

Barriers: Recipient preference for physical gifts, Personalising an experience correctly

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.8 kg | Water 20 L | Waste 0.2 kg

17. Delete a shopping app

Difficulty 1 | 2 min | free | global

Delete one shopping app from your phone that you use for impulse browsing.

Instructions

- Identify one shopping app you browse habitually
- Delete it from your phone
- If you genuinely need to buy something, use the website version (more friction = fewer impulse buys)

Why it matters: Shopping app users spend an average of 5× more per year than people who shop only via desktop browsers.

Tips

- Amazon, ASOS, and Shein are the biggest impulse-buying drivers
- Move the app to a hidden folder first if full deletion feels too drastic

Barriers: Genuine regular use of the app

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.8 kg | Water 20 L | Waste 0.2 kg

18. Choose a slow fashion brand

Difficulty 2 | 20 min | low | global

Research and buy from a slow fashion brand that makes durable, ethical clothing.

Instructions

- Research a brand using Good On You app
- Choose one rated Good or Great
- Buy one item and assess quality vs. your usual brands

Why it matters: Slow fashion items are designed to last 5-10 years vs. fast fashion's 7-10 wears before disposal.

Tips

- Arket, Thought Clothing, and Patagonia are well-rated slow fashion brands
- Cost per wear is the right metric, a \$200 item worn 200 times costs \$1 per wear

Barriers: Higher upfront cost, Limited style range in some categories

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.8 kg | Water 20 L | Waste 0.2 kg

19. Swap a convenience purchase for homemade

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | free | global

Make something at home you normally buy packaged, granola, bread, or cleaning spray.

Instructions

- Choose one convenience product you buy regularly
- Find a simple recipe online
- Make it at home and compare cost and taste

Why it matters: Convenience foods often cost 3-10× as much as homemade equivalents and generate far more packaging.

Tips

- Overnight oats, granola, and hummus are the easiest first swaps
- Batch making saves time across the week

Barriers: Time, Perceived complexity

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.8 kg | Water 20 L | Waste 0.2 kg

20. Stop buying single-use plastic wrap

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | low | global

Replace cling film and zip-lock bags with reusable alternatives.

Instructions

- Use up your remaining cling wrap
- Replace with silicone stretch lids, beeswax wraps, or glass containers
- Never buy cling film again

Why it matters: Cling wrap is largely non-recyclable and breaks down into microplastics in landfill.

Tips

- Silicone stretch lids come in sets of 6-10 for under \$15
- Stasher silicone bags replace zip-lock bags indefinitely

Barriers: Raw meat handling (use silicone bags or containers instead)

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.3 kg

21. Review your pension or super fund

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | free | global

Check where your pension or superannuation fund invests and switch to an ethical option if available.

Instructions

- Log into your pension or super fund
- Search for their investment policy on fossil fuels
- Switch to their ethical or sustainable option if available

Why it matters: Your pension may have 20-50× more climate impact than all your personal consumption decisions combined.

Tips

- Australian Ethical, HESTA, and Aware Super are highly rated sustainable super funds
- Future Super and Good Super are fossil-fuel-free options in Australia

Barriers: Complex fund options, Fear of performance impact

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

22. Mend before discarding

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | free | global

Sew up a hole, replace a button, or patch a garment rather than discarding it.

Instructions

- Find a garment with a minor fault
- YouTube basic repair for the specific issue
- Repair with needle and thread or a patch

Why it matters: A T-shirt requires 2,700 litres of water to produce. Extending its life by one year reduces its climate impact by 24%.

Tips

- Visible mending is a growing craft, patches and darning add character
- Iron-on patches fix holes in seconds with no sewing required

Barriers: Sewing skills, Time

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.8 kg | Water 20 L | Waste 0.2 kg

23. Research circular economy brands

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Find one brand in your sector that offers take-back or cradle-to-cradle design.

Instructions

- Think of a category of goods you buy regularly
- Research brands with take-back or circular design programmes
- Switch to them next time you need to purchase

Why it matters: Circular economy brands design for repair, reuse, and recycling, eliminating waste by design rather than trying to manage it after the fact.

Tips

- Patagonia's Worn Wear, IKEA buy-back, and Fairphone are examples
- Ellen MacArthur Foundation's website profiles hundreds of circular brands

Barriers: Not available in all product categories, Higher price point

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

24. Buy local instead of imported

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | low | global

For one purchase this week, choose a locally made product over an imported equivalent.

Instructions

- Think of something you're about to buy
- Search for a locally made version
- Buy local even if it costs slightly more

Why it matters: Local products reduce shipping emissions and support local employment, both environmental and social wins.

Tips

- Farmers markets, local craft fairs, and independent shops stock local goods
- Google "made in [your city/country]" for almost any product category

Barriers: Limited local options in some categories, Cost premium for handmade local goods

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.8 kg | Water 20 L | Waste 0.2 kg

25. Avoid the dryer by buying quick-dry fabric

Difficulty 2 | 20 min | low | global

Research quick-dry fabric alternatives to cotton for your next clothing purchase.

Instructions

- Look up merino wool, bamboo, or technical fabric options
- Find a garment in one of these materials
- Compare long-term wash and dry cost vs. cotton

Why it matters: Merino wool and synthetic athletic fabrics dry in 1-2 hours rather than 4-6 hours, largely eliminating tumble dryer need.

Tips

- Merino T-shirts from Icebreaker or Unbound can be worn multiple days before washing
- Quick-dry fabrics reduce wash frequency, extending garment life

Barriers: Higher upfront cost, Animal welfare concerns with wool (choose certified ethical wool)

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.8 kg | Water 20 L | Waste 0.2 kg

26. Find your region's repair café

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Search for and locate your nearest repair café where volunteers fix items for free.

Instructions

- Go to repaircafe.org and find your nearest location
- Collect one broken item to bring along
- Attend and get it fixed for free

Why it matters: There are 2,500+ repair cafés worldwide fixing thousands of items per year that would otherwise go to landfill.

Tips

- Items commonly repaired: clothes, bikes, electronics, appliances, furniture
- You also learn the repair skill while the volunteer guides you

Barriers: Distance from the nearest café, Opening hours

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.8 kg | Water 20 L | Waste 0.2 kg

27. Switch to a reusable period product

Difficulty 2 | 20 min | low | global

Replace disposable period products with a reusable alternative.

Instructions

- Research menstrual cups, discs, or period underwear
- Choose the option that fits your lifestyle
- Purchase and use for a full cycle

Why it matters: The average person uses 11,000 disposable period products in their lifetime. Reusables eliminate this entirely.

Tips

- Menstrual cups last 10+ years and save \$100+/year
- WUKA and Modibodi period underwear are the most popular brands

Barriers: Learning curve, Cultural or religious considerations

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.3 kg

28. Invest one hour in learning about conscious consumption

Difficulty 1 | 60 min | free | global

Watch a documentary or read a long-form article on sustainable consumption.

Instructions

- Choose from: The True Cost (fashion), Cowspiracy (food), or The Story of Stuff (consumer goods)
- Watch or read without distractions
- Write down 3 things you'll change

Why it matters: Education is the highest-leverage action, understanding the system changes all future decisions.

Tips

- The Story of Stuff is a free 20-minute YouTube film, perfect starting point
- The Good Stuff is Annie Leonard's companion guide for practical change

Barriers: Time, Overwhelm from what you learn

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.8 kg | Water 20 L | Waste 0.2 kg

Biodiversity (31)

1. Plant a native species

Difficulty 2 | 60 min | low | global

Plant one native tree, shrub, or wildflower to support local wildlife.

Instructions

- Visit a native plant nursery or order online
- Choose a species native to your region
- Plant in a sunny spot with good drainage

Why it matters: Native plants support 10-50× more insect species than ornamental exotics, forming the base of local food webs.

Tips

- Ask your local council for free native tree schemes
- Wildflower seed bombs are an easy apartment-friendly start

Barriers: No outdoor space, Renting

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 5 L | Waste 0 kg

2. Create a bee water station

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Set up a shallow dish of water with pebbles for bees and insects to drink safely.

Instructions

- Find a shallow dish or upturned bin lid
- Add pebbles or marbles for landing surfaces
- Fill with clean water and place in a sunny spot

Why it matters: Bees dehydrate quickly in summer. A water station can support hundreds of bees from the surrounding area.

Tips

- Change the water every 2 days to prevent mosquitoes
- Place near flowering plants for maximum benefit

Barriers: No outdoor space

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 5 L | Waste 0 kg

3. Leave a patch of lawn unmowed

Difficulty 1 | 5 min | free | global

Designate a corner of your lawn as a wild patch and leave it unmowed for a month.

Instructions

- Mark out a 1m² patch in a corner
- Leave it unmowed for 30 days
- Observe what insects and plants appear

Why it matters: Long grass supports grasshoppers, beetles, spiders, and small mammals, all important parts of local food webs.

Tips

- Add a small sign "Wildlife Habitat" if you're worried about neighbours
- Even a 1m² patch makes a difference in a lawn desert

Barriers: HOA or body corporate rules, Aesthetic preference

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 5 L | Waste 0 kg

4. Build an insect hotel

Difficulty 2 | 60 min | low | global

Build a simple insect hotel from bamboo tubes, pine cones, and straw to provide nesting habitat.

Instructions

- Collect bamboo canes, pine cones, and dry straw
- Pack into a wooden frame or old pallet
- Hang or place in a sunny, sheltered spot

Why it matters: Solitary bees, which pollinate 80% of crops, nest in hollow stems. Insect hotels can host dozens of species.

Tips

- South or east-facing spots get morning sun that bees prefer
- Bamboo canes 5-10mm diameter are perfect for mason bees

Barriers: No outdoor space, Tools required

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 5 L | Waste 0 kg

5. Stop using pesticides in your garden

Difficulty 2 | 20 min | free | global

Replace chemical pesticides with companion planting or hand-removal of pests.

Instructions

- Identify pests and research natural deterrents
- Plant marigolds, lavender, or garlic near vulnerable plants
- Hand-remove slugs and aphids instead of spraying

Why it matters: Pesticides kill beneficial insects including bees, lacewings, and ground beetles alongside target pests.

Tips

- Neem oil is an effective organic spray that is safe for bees when dry
- Copper tape around pots deters slugs permanently

Barriers: Severe pest pressure, Large garden area

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 5 L | Waste 0 kg

6. Join a citizen science survey

Difficulty 1 | 30 min | free | global

Contribute wildlife sightings to a national biodiversity database.

Instructions

- Download iNaturalist, eBird, or your national wildlife app
- Photograph a plant, bird, or insect in your area
- Upload the observation with location data

Why it matters: Citizen science surveys have recorded 2+ billion wildlife observations, the most comprehensive biodiversity dataset ever assembled.

Tips

- iNaturalist uses AI to identify species from photos instantly
- RSPB Big Garden Birdwatch runs every January in the UK

Barriers: Identification skills (apps help with this), Urban areas with less wildlife

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

7. Put up a bird box

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | low | global

Install a nest box suitable for a local bird species.

Instructions

- Buy or build a nest box sized for your local birds
- Mount 2-5m high on a north or east-facing wall or tree
- Leave undisturbed until nesting season ends in late summer

Why it matters: Urban bird populations have declined 20-60% since 1970 due to loss of natural nesting cavities.

Tips

- Hole size determines which species will use it, 25mm for blue tits, 32mm for house sparrows
- Clean the box out in autumn after nesting season

Barriers: No suitable wall or tree, Renting

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 5 L | Waste 0 kg

8. Remove an invasive plant

Difficulty 2 | 60 min | free | global

Identify and remove one invasive plant species from your garden or a local greenspace.

Instructions

- Research invasive plants in your region
- Identify one in your area
- Remove roots completely, bag and bin, never compost invasives

Why it matters: Invasive plants outcompete native species and can reduce local biodiversity by up to 50% in affected areas.

Tips

- Japanese knotweed, rhododendron, and Himalayan balsam are common UK invasives
- Check council invasive plant removal days for support

Barriers: Physical effort for large infestations, Identification uncertainty

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 5 L | Waste 0 kg

9. Plant a wildflower patch

Difficulty 2 | 60 min | low | global

Sow a mix of native wildflower seeds in a bare patch of garden.

Instructions

- Prepare a small patch by removing grass and loosening soil
- Scatter wildflower seed mix appropriate for your region
- Water in and leave, no fertiliser needed

Why it matters: A single square metre of wildflower meadow can support 100+ insect species throughout the flowering season.

Tips

- Autumn or early spring are the best sowing times
- RHS recommends native UK wildflower mixes, avoid cultivars

Barriers: No garden space, Competitive grass preventing establishment

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 5 L | Waste 0 kg

10. Avoid peat compost

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Choose peat-free compost for all gardening this year.

Instructions

- Check the bag, many composts are peat-free now
- Choose coir, bark, or wood-fibre based alternatives
- Avoid any compost listing peat as an ingredient

Why it matters: Peatlands store twice as much carbon as all the world's forests combined. Mining them for compost releases this carbon.

Tips

- Miracle-Gro Performance Organics and Westland Multipurpose are peat-free
- Home compost is always peat-free and free

Barriers: Some specialist plants still prefer peat-based mix

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.5 kg

11. Feed the birds in winter

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | low | global

Set up a bird feeder with appropriate seed for your local species.

Instructions

- Buy a feeder and appropriate seed mix
- Hang at least 1.5m off the ground, away from cat ambush spots
- Keep topped up through winter and clean fortnightly

Why it matters: Garden birds lose 10% of body weight on cold nights. Supplementary feeding increases winter survival rates significantly.

Tips

- Sunflower hearts attract the widest range of species
- Fat balls provide the highest energy, especially for tits and woodpeckers

Barriers: Cats in the garden, No suitable hanging spot

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 5 L | Waste 0 kg

12. Create a log pile habitat

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Stack a pile of old logs or branches in a shady corner as habitat for beetles, fungi, and small mammals.

Instructions

- Collect fallen branches or use offcuts
- Stack loosely in a shady corner
- Leave undisturbed, the rot process is the habitat

Why it matters: Stag beetles and over 1,000 other invertebrate species rely on dead wood. Most gardens have none.

Tips

- The bigger the logs the better for stag beetles
- Bury the bottom log partially for maximum moisture retention

Barriers: No source of logs, Aesthetic concerns

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 5 L | Waste 0 kg

13. Go on a local nature walk

Difficulty 1 | 60 min | free | global

Spend an hour walking in a local greenspace, actively observing plants, birds, and insects.

Instructions

- Choose a local park, nature reserve, or hedgerow walk
- Take a wildflower or bird ID guide (or use an app)
- Slow down and actively look, under leaves, in bark, by water

Why it matters: Nature connection is a stronger predictor of pro-environmental behaviour than knowledge alone.

Tips

- Early morning is best for birdsong
- The Woodland Trust app identifies UK trees from leaf photos

Barriers: Mobility limitations, Urban area with limited greenspace

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 5 L | Waste 0 kg

14. Buy FSC-certified wood products

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Check that any wood or paper products you buy carry the FSC certification.

Instructions

- Look for the FSC logo on wood, paper, furniture, and packaging
- Reject products with no certification if an FSC alternative exists
- Check one product you buy regularly and find an FSC equivalent

Why it matters: FSC-certified forests are managed to protect biodiversity, water quality, and indigenous rights.

Tips

- IKEA uses FSC-certified wood across most product lines
- All major paper brands have FSC options

Barriers: FSC products not always available or priced competitively

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 5 L | Waste 0 kg

15. Choose Rainforest Alliance certified coffee or tea

Difficulty 1 | 5 min | low | global

Switch to Rainforest Alliance or Fair Trade certified coffee or tea.

Instructions

- Check your current brand for certification
- If uncertified, find a Rainforest Alliance alternative
- Look for the green frog logo

Why it matters: Coffee and tea plantations drive deforestation in tropical biodiversity hotspots. Certification requires shade-grown and wildlife-friendly practices.

Tips

- Pact Coffee, Ozone, and Clipper Tea are well-certified options
- Fairtrade certification also covers environmental standards

Barriers: Cost premium, Brand loyalty

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 5 L | Waste 0 kg

16. Avoid single-use fireworks

Difficulty 2 | 5 min | free | global

Skip or campaign against fireworks displays near wildlife habitats.

Instructions

- Research light shows or silent events as alternatives for celebrations
- Sign local petitions against fireworks in nature reserves
- Contact local council about silent firework policies

Why it matters: Fireworks cause extreme stress in birds and mammals, nesting failures, stampedes, and heart attacks in sensitive species.

Tips

- Many councils now offer laser light show alternatives
- Drone light shows are a growing zero-noise alternative

Barriers: Cultural tradition, Limited authority as an individual

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.3 kg

17. Volunteer for a tree planting event

Difficulty 2 | 180 min | free | global

Join a community tree planting day with a local conservation group.

Instructions

- Search "tree planting volunteer [your city]"
- Register for an upcoming event
- Attend and plant!

Why it matters: Community tree planting events typically plant 200-500 trees per session, each tree absorbing 20+ kg CO₂/year.

Tips

- The Conservation Volunteers (TCV) runs planting days across the UK
- One Tree Planted and Trees for Life coordinate global events

Barriers: Availability, Physical fitness

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 5 L | Waste 0 kg

18. Install a hedgehog highway

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | low | global

Cut or create a 13cm gap in your garden fence to allow hedgehogs to roam freely.

Instructions

- Identify a fence panel in your garden
- Cut or create a 13×13cm hole at ground level
- Inform your neighbour and encourage them to do the same

Why it matters: Hedgehog populations have declined 50% since 2000, partly due to garden fencing blocking their 2km nightly roaming range.

Tips

- The British Hedgehog Preservation Society has template cut-out guides
- Register your highway at hedgehogstreet.org to map connected gardens

Barriers: Neighbour cooperation, Renting

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 5 L | Waste 0 kg

19. Choose palm-oil-free cosmetics

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | low | global

Check your cosmetics and personal care products for palm oil derivatives and find alternatives.

Instructions

- Check ingredient lists for palm oil, palmitate, sodium lauryl sulphate (palm-derived)
- Use the Palm Oil Scan app for product checks
- Replace one product with a palm-oil-free alternative

Why it matters: Palm oil expansion has destroyed 3.5 million hectares of Borneo rainforest, habitat for critically endangered orangutans.

Tips

- Ethique solid bars are palm-oil-free and packaging-free
- Dr Bronner's uses RSPO certified palm oil as a minimum standard

Barriers: Palm oil is in 70% of cosmetics under many names, Availability of alternatives

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 5 L | Waste 0 kg

20. Report a wildlife sighting

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Submit a wildlife sighting to your national biodiversity database.

Instructions

- Note the species, location, time, and number seen
- Submit via iNaturalist, iRecord (UK), or your national platform
- Add a photo if possible

Why it matters: Verified wildlife records help scientists track population trends and inform conservation funding decisions.

Tips

- Any sighting counts, from garden robin to urban fox
- Apps like Seek (by iNaturalist) identify species from photos instantly

Barriers: Uncertainty about species ID, No wildlife visible in area

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 5 L | Waste 0 kg

21. Plant for pollinators

Difficulty 1 | 30 min | low | global

Add one pot or border of pollinator-friendly flowers.

Instructions

- Buy lavender, borage, phacelia, or a wildflower mix
- Plant in a sunny spot visible from a window
- Avoid double-flowered cultivars, they produce no pollen

Why it matters: Pollinators are responsible for 1 in 3 bites of food we eat. Urban gardens are now critical refuges for bees and butterflies.

Tips

- Phacelia is the single most attractive plant to bees
- Lavender, alliums, and catmint are near-indestructible pollinator magnets

Barriers: No garden or balcony, Shady location

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 5 L | Waste 0 kg

22. Reduce light pollution for wildlife

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Turn off unnecessary outdoor lights at night to protect nocturnal wildlife.

Instructions

- Identify any outdoor lights left on overnight
- Switch to motion-sensor or timer-controlled lighting
- Turn off decorative lights by 10pm

Why it matters: Artificial light at night disrupts the navigation of 33% of vertebrate species and kills billions of insects attracted to bulbs.

Tips

- Warm amber LED bulbs attract fewer insects than cool white
- Motion sensors save electricity and protect wildlife simultaneously

Barriers: Security concerns, Renting, no control over outdoor lights

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 5 L | Waste 0 kg

23. Choose sustainably sourced seafood

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | low | global

Check the sustainability rating of any seafood you buy using a guide or app.

Instructions

- Download the Marine Conservation Society Good Fish Guide
- Check each fish or shellfish you plan to buy
- Avoid red-rated species and choose green-rated alternatives

Why it matters: 90% of the world's fish stocks are fully or overexploited. Choosing sustainably rated fish directly reduces pressure on threatened species.

Tips

- Mussels, oysters, and mackerel are consistently green-rated
- MSC blue label is the most widely recognised certification on packaging

Barriers: Limited choice at local fishmonger, Higher cost of certified options

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 5 L | Waste 0 kg

24. Support a conservation charity

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | low | global

Make a small donation or take out a membership with a wildlife conservation organisation.

Instructions

- Choose a local wildlife trust, WWF, or specialist charity
- Make a one-off or monthly donation
- Share their work on social media to amplify impact

Why it matters: Conservation charities protect millions of hectares of critical habitat, £1 donated to an effective charity protects far more than individual garden actions.

Tips

- Local wildlife trusts often protect more habitat per pound than global charities
- Adopting an acre of rainforest is a popular and tangible gift option

Barriers: Budget constraints, Uncertainty about which charities are effective

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 5 L | Waste 0 kg

25. Avoid products with endangered species ingredients

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Check products for ingredients derived from endangered or protected species.

Instructions

- Check traditional medicines, supplements, and exotic cosmetics
- Research any unfamiliar ingredient
- Refuse any product derived from shark, rhino, turtle, or other CITES-listed species

Why it matters: Consumer demand for shark fin, rhino horn, and turtle shell directly funds the poaching trade that drives species to extinction.

Tips

- Apps like Wildlife Witness report suspicious products
- TRAFFIC's Wildlife Trade Monitoring Network maintains updated lists

Barriers: Ingredient transparency in supply chains

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 5 L | Waste 0 kg

26. Create a pond or water feature

Difficulty 3 | 180 min | low | global

Build a small wildlife pond to provide habitat for frogs, dragonflies, and aquatic plants.

Instructions

- Dig a hole with graduated depth, shallow edges for drinking
- Line with a butyl pond liner
- Fill with rainwater and plant native aquatic species

Why it matters: A single small pond can support 1,000+ species of invertebrate. Garden ponds are the most effective single biodiversity action.

Tips

- Even a half-barrel of water with no liner is valuable
- Add oxygenating plants (hornwort) and a gently sloped exit for hedgehogs

Barriers: Cost, Space, Children safety concerns

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 5 L | Waste 0 kg

27. Read about local endangered species

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Research one species endangered in your region and what is threatening it.

Instructions

- Search "[your country] endangered species list"
- Choose one that interests you
- Read one article or watch a short documentary about it

Why it matters: Knowledge of local threatened species is the first step to caring about and acting on biodiversity loss.

Tips

- IUCN Red List is the most comprehensive global resource
- WWF country pages summarise key threatened species

Barriers: Overwhelming information, Emotional difficulty of learning about extinction

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

28. Grow food for wildlife

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | low | global

Let one plant go to seed rather than deadheading, the seeds feed birds and insects.

Instructions

- Choose a plant going to seed: sunflower, verbena, or teasel
- Leave the seed heads on the plant
- Observe which birds or insects visit

Why it matters: Teasel seed heads feed goldfinches all winter. Sunflower heads support up to 50 bird visits per day.

Tips

- Verbena bonariensis is one of the most wildlife-valuable garden plants
- Leaving seed heads also adds winter garden structure and beauty

Barriers: Aesthetic preference for tidiness, HOA rules

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 5 L | Waste 0 kg

29. Buy organic to protect pollinators

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | low | global

Switch to organic versions of the pesticide-heaviest produce items.

Instructions

- Research the Dirty Dozen list (most pesticide-laden crops)
- Buy organic for at least 3 items on the list
- Wash all non-organic produce thoroughly

Why it matters: Neonicotinoid pesticides used on conventional crops are lethal to bees even at sub-lethal doses, organic farms ban them.

Tips

- The Dirty Dozen: strawberries, spinach, grapes, apples, and peppers top the list
- Organic doesn't always cost more, seasonal and local organic is competitive

Barriers: Cost premium, Limited availability

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 5 L | Waste 0 kg

30. Adopt a wild animal symbolically

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | low | global

Make a symbolic adoption donation to a wildlife charity protecting an endangered species.

Instructions

- Choose a species you care about
- Find a reputable charity offering symbolic adoption
- Donate, you'll typically receive a certificate and updates

Why it matters: Symbolic adoptions fund real conservation fieldwork, anti-poaching patrols, habitat restoration, and community ranger programmes.

Tips

- WWF, Born Free, and IFAW offer adoptions for hundreds of species
- It makes a meaningful and waste-free gift

Barriers: Budget, Preference for direct action

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 5 L | Waste 0 kg

31. Use a bee-safe garden spray

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | low | global

Switch any garden spray to a bee-safe organic alternative.

Instructions

- Check your current garden sprays for neonicotinoids or permethrin
- Replace with neem oil, insecticidal soap, or diatomaceous earth
- Only spray at dusk when bees have returned to hives

Why it matters: Pyrethroid insecticides kill bees on contact. Organic sprays break down within hours and are safe when applied correctly.

Tips

- Apply any spray, even organic, at dusk to avoid foraging bees
- Diatomaceous earth is effective against crawling insects without harming bees

Barriers: Effectiveness on severe infestations

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 5 L | Waste 0 kg

Circular Economy (27)

1. Understand your product's end of life

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Research what happens to one product you use when you're done with it.

Instructions

- Pick one regularly replaced product (phone, clothing, appliance)
- Search "[product] end of life disposal"
- Find the most responsible disposal route for your region

Why it matters: Only 9% of plastic ever produced has been recycled. Understanding disposal routes is the first step to closing the loop.

Tips

- Manufacturer take-back programmes exist for most major electronics
- TerraCycle accepts products that are otherwise unrecyclable

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

2. Buy a refurbished phone or device

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | low | global

For your next device, buy refurbished rather than new.

Instructions

- Research refurbished options for the device you need
- Choose a Grade A refurbished model from a reputable seller
- Check the warranty and return policy before buying

Why it matters: Manufacturing a new smartphone produces 70 kg CO₂. A refurbished phone reuses 95% of that embodied energy.

Tips

- Back Market, Renewed, and Swappa offer certified refurbished devices
- Apple and Samsung now sell certified refurbished devices directly

Barriers: Concern about condition, Limited model availability

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1 kg | Water 10 L | Waste 0.3 kg

3. Use a product as a service

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | low | global

Explore a product-as-a-service model for something you normally buy.

Instructions

- Research subscription or leasing models for a product category you use
- Compare total cost and environmental impact vs. buying new
- Try a service-based model for one item

Why it matters: Product-as-a-service incentivises manufacturers to build for durability, they retain ownership and profit from long product life.

Tips

- Rent the Runway (fashion), Brother (printers), and Michelin (tyres) are established PaaS models
- Library of Things offers tool rental as a service in many UK cities

Barriers: Not available for all product types, Long-term cost can exceed buying

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1 kg | Water 10 L | Waste 0.3 kg

4. Disassemble something before discarding

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | free | global

Before throwing away a broken appliance, disassemble it to separate metals, plastics, and electronics.

Instructions

- Take apart a broken toaster, fan, or similar appliance
- Separate metal, plastic, and circuit boards
- Recycle each stream separately at the appropriate facility

Why it matters: Mixed-material waste cannot be efficiently recycled. Disassembly recovers valuable materials, copper, steel, and rare earth metals.

Tips

- iFixit.com has disassembly guides for hundreds of products
- Metal from appliances is almost always recyclable at council tips

Barriers: Safety with electrical items (ensure disconnected), Time required

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1 kg | Water 10 L | Waste 0.3 kg

5. Choose packaging-free where possible

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Do one shop choosing only unpackaged or minimally packaged goods.

Instructions

- Visit a zero-waste shop, market, or farm shop
- Bring your own bags and containers
- Buy only loose or paper-packaged products

Why it matters: Zero-waste stores eliminate packaging entirely, proving the circular model works commercially at scale.

Tips

- Refill apps map zero-waste shops near you
- Buying loose at supermarkets is the next-best option if no zero-waste shop exists

Barriers: No zero-waste shop nearby, Limited loose product availability

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1 kg | Water 10 L | Waste 0.3 kg

6. Refill a cleaning product

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | low | global

Refill your cleaning product at a refill station or with a concentrated tablet/pod.

Instructions

- Find a cleaning product refill station or concentrated refill system
- Refill your existing bottle rather than buying a new one
- Or switch to Smol, Ecover, or Method concentrate systems

Why it matters: Cleaning product bottles are 90% water. Refillable concentrates eliminate packaging and transport emissions.

Tips

- Splosh and Smol deliver dissolvable tablet refills by post
- Ecover and Method have refill stations in most UK Waitrose and Holland & Barrett stores

Barriers: Refill station not available locally, Product preference

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1 kg | Water 10 L | Waste 0.3 kg

7. Learn about the Ellen MacArthur Foundation

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Explore the Ellen MacArthur Foundation's resources on circular economy principles.

Instructions

- Visit ellenmacarthurfoundation.org
- Read one article or watch one video on circular economy principles
- Note one industry example that surprised you

Why it matters: The Ellen MacArthur Foundation estimates a circular economy could reduce global carbon emissions by 45% beyond energy transition alone.

Tips

- The Foundation's CE100 network includes hundreds of businesses committing to circular principles
- Their animated videos are an accessible introduction for all levels

Barriers: Technical language in some resources, Time to engage in depth

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

8. Repair a household appliance

Difficulty 2 | 60 min | low | global

Fix a broken household appliance rather than replacing it.

Instructions

- Identify a broken appliance worth repairing
- Find the repair guide at iFixit or YouTube
- Order the required part and repair it

Why it matters: Repairing appliances keeps embodied carbon in use and avoids the 10-30× higher carbon cost of manufacturing a replacement.

Tips

- ReplaceDirect and Partmaster stock spare parts for most UK appliances
- Many councils offer repair grants or loans for boilers and white goods

Barriers: Spare parts availability, Technical complexity for some items

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1 kg | Water 10 L | Waste 0.3 kg

9. Choose modular or repairable products

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | low | global

For your next technology purchase, research modular or easily repairable options.

Instructions

- Research repairability scores for products in your category
- Find a product with a high iFixit or Repair Index score
- Buy based on repairability as a factor

Why it matters: Right to Repair legislation now requires EU and UK manufacturers to supply spare parts for 10 years after product launch.

Tips

- Fairphone scores 10/10 on iFixit for repairability
- Framework laptop is the most repairable laptop available

Barriers: Limited modular options in most categories, Higher upfront cost

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1 kg | Water 10 L | Waste 0.3 kg

10. Sell something on a resale platform

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

List at least one item you no longer need on a resale platform.

Instructions

- Photograph and list one item on Vinted, eBay, or Facebook Marketplace
- Set a fair price
- Ship or arrange handover within 48 hours of sale

Why it matters: The resale market keeps items in use, earning money for the seller and saving 80-95% of the carbon cost of buying new for the buyer.

Tips

- Good photos and accurate descriptions lead to fast sales
- Vinted is the fastest-growing resale platform in the UK for clothing

Barriers: Time to photograph and list items, Dealing with buyer queries

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1 kg | Water 10 L | Waste 0.3 kg

11. Look for take-back programmes

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Research take-back or recycling programmes for a product you're done with.

Instructions

- Identify something you want to dispose of: mattress, phone, clothing
- Search "[brand/product] take-back programme"
- Use the programme rather than bin disposal

Why it matters: Many manufacturers now offer take-back, Apple, IKEA, H&M, and most phone brands. The material is reused or recycled properly.

Tips

- TerraCycle fills gaps for items without manufacturer take-back
- IKEA's buyback scheme takes back furniture in most countries

Barriers: Take-back not available for all products, Transport required

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1 kg | Water 10 L | Waste 0.3 kg

12. Try a clothes rental subscription

Difficulty 2 | 20 min | low | global

Subscribe to a clothing rental service for a month instead of buying new outfits.

Instructions

- Research clothing rental services in your country
- Choose a subscription level appropriate for your needs
- Rent instead of buying for all occasions this month

Why it matters: Rental extends garment life by 10-20× versus fast fashion, dramatically reducing production demand.

Tips

- Rent the Runway (US), By Rotation (UK), and Hurr are leading platforms
- Designer and occasion wear rental is most cost-effective vs. buying

Barriers: Fit and condition uncertainty, Availability of preferred styles

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1 kg | Water 10 L | Waste 0.3 kg

13. Upcycle a piece of furniture

Difficulty 2 | 120 min | low | global

Transform a tired piece of furniture into something you'd want to keep with paint, fabric, or new handles.

Instructions

- Find a piece of furniture worth upcycling
- Research techniques appropriate to the material
- Carry out the upcycle and share the result

Why it matters: Upcycling furniture avoids landfill and the 50+ kg CO₂ cost of manufacturing new flat-pack equivalent.

Tips

- Annie Sloan chalk paint requires no preparation and transforms wood
- Reupholstering a chair seat is a beginner-friendly first project

Barriers: DIY skills, Space to work, Time

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1 kg | Water 10 L | Waste 0.3 kg

14. Investigate right to repair for your broken item

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

If a product broke, research your right to have it repaired under consumer protection law.

Instructions

- Check your country's consumer rights on repair
- Contact the manufacturer about a repair under warranty or right to repair rules
- Escalate to a consumer protection body if refused

Why it matters: The EU and UK Right to Repair regulations require manufacturers to make spare parts available and not obstruct repairs.

Tips

- Citizens Advice (UK) covers product repair rights clearly
- Which? has a template letter for requesting repair under the Consumer Rights Act

Barriers: Out of warranty items, Manufacturer resistance

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1 kg | Water 10 L | Waste 0.3 kg

15. Donate tech to a digital inclusion charity

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Donate old but working tech to a charity that refurbishes it for people without digital access.

Instructions

- Find a working but unused device
- Wipe all personal data using a factory reset
- Donate to Reconnect, Computer Aid International, or a local digital inclusion programme

Why it matters: Donated devices prevent e-waste and provide digital access to people excluded by cost, solving two problems simultaneously.

Tips

- Computers for Schools accepts working devices in many countries
- WEEEcharity recycles non-working devices and donates proceeds to charity

Barriers: Data wiping concern, Finding a trustworthy charity

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

16. Calculate the true cost of fast fashion

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Calculate the full environmental cost of 5 clothing items using a fashion footprint calculator.

Instructions

- Find a fashion carbon calculator (Remake, Sourcemap, or similar)
- Enter 5 recent clothing purchases
- Note the total CO₂, water, and waste generated

Why it matters: A single pair of jeans uses 7,500L of water and produces 33 kg CO₂, more than driving 130 km.

Tips

- The Higg Index gives brand-level data on fashion footprints
 - Use the calculation to set a personal clothes-buying budget for CO₂
- Barriers:** Data not always available for all brands, Can be overwhelming

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

17. Buy from a closed-loop brand

Difficulty 2 | 20 min | low | global

Research and buy from a brand that takes back its own products to recycle into new ones.

Instructions

- Research brands with genuine closed-loop programmes
- Verify their take-back and recycling claims
- Buy from them and register your product for take-back at end of life

Why it matters: Closed-loop brands like Patagonia (Worn Wear), Adidas (Stan Smiths from ocean plastic), and Interface (carpet tiles from old carpet) demonstrate the circular model at scale.

Tips

- Interface Re-Entry takes back any carpet tile for recycling, even competitors' tiles
- Patagonia's Worn Wear programme repairs, resells, and recycles their garments

Barriers: Limited options in many product categories, Higher price point

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1 kg | Water 10 L | Waste 0.3 kg

18. Learn about planned obsolescence

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Research planned obsolescence and how it drives waste in electronics and fashion.

Instructions

- Search "planned obsolescence documentary" or read one article
- Identify one category where you've experienced it personally
- Note one brand that resists it

Why it matters: Planned obsolescence cost EU consumers €200 billion per year in premature product replacements.

Tips

- The Lightbulb Conspiracy documentary covers planned obsolescence history from 1924
- French law now requires manufacturers to declare reparability scores

Barriers: Widespread and deeply embedded in product design, Systemic issue needing policy change

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

19. Return a product under extended producer responsibility

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Return a product at end of life using an extended producer responsibility scheme.

Instructions

- Find a product that qualifies: batteries, tyres, electronics, mattresses
- Locate the return point (usually retailer or manufacturer)
- Return it rather than binning it

Why it matters: Extended Producer Responsibility laws make manufacturers responsible for end-of-life management, participation is the demand signal that makes it work.

Tips

- Batteries must be taken back by any shop that sells them in the EU and UK
- Mattress recycling is available from most council tips

Barriers: Transport of bulky items, Not knowing which products qualify

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1 kg | Water 10 L | Waste 0.3 kg

20. Compost bioplastics correctly

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Learn the difference between home-compostable and industrially compostable bioplastics and dispose of each correctly.

Instructions

- Find a bioplastic item (packaging labelled compostable)
- Check whether it's home or industrial compostable
- Dispose accordingly, industrial compostable to food waste bin, not home compost

Why it matters: Most bioplastics need industrial composting at 60°C+, thrown in home compost or general waste, they cause harm.

Tips

- "Home compostable" certification means it breaks down in your compost bin
- "Compostable" alone usually means industrial, it's poorly labelled across the industry

Barriers: Confusing and inconsistent labelling, No industrial composting collection available

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.5 kg

21. Swap items with a friend

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Organise a mini swap meet with 2-3 friends, exchange items you no longer use for things you need.

Instructions

- Message 2-3 friends about a swap
- Each person brings 3-5 items they no longer use
- Swap freely, any unclaimed items go to charity

Why it matters: Swapping extends product life at zero financial or environmental cost, the circular economy at its most direct.

Tips

- Swaps work brilliantly for books, clothes, kitchenware, plants, and seeds
- Olio facilitates virtual swapping with a larger community

Barriers: Organising schedules, Nothing left to swap

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1 kg | Water 10 L | Waste 0.3 kg

22. Shop at a zero-waste store

Difficulty 2 | 45 min | low | global

Visit a zero-waste or package-free shop and do part of your weekly shop there.

Instructions

- Find your nearest zero-waste store (use Refill.org.uk app)
- Bring containers for dry goods, liquids, and cleaning products
- Buy your staples package-free

Why it matters: Zero-waste shops close the loop entirely on packaging, proving the circular retail model is commercially viable.

Tips

- Bring a range of containers, large for grains, small for spices
- Many zero-waste shops also refill cleaning products and toiletries

Barriers: No zero-waste store nearby, Planning ahead with containers

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1 kg | Water 10 L | Waste 0.3 kg

23. Track your waste for a week

Difficulty 2 | 10 min | free | global

Record every piece of waste you generate for 7 days to identify patterns.

Instructions

- Note every item you throw away for 7 days
- Categorise by type: plastic, food, paper, other
- Identify the single largest waste stream and research a circular alternative

Why it matters: Households that track waste for one week reduce it by 20% within the following month through simple awareness.

Tips

- A tally chart by category is faster than detailed notes
- Focus on the top 3 items by volume, that's where most waste reduction is available

Barriers: Persistence to track for a full week, Overwhelming amount of waste to confront

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1 kg | Water 10 L | Waste 0.3 kg

24. Investigate industrial symbiosis

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Research how businesses in your area share waste streams as inputs to each other's production.

Instructions

- Search "industrial symbiosis [your region]"
- Read one example of a business waste stream becoming another's raw material
- Note whether any business near you participates

Why it matters: Kalundborg Symbiosis in Denmark has exchanged waste streams between 11 companies since 1972, eliminating 635,000 tonnes of CO₂ per year.

Tips

- The National Industrial Symbiosis Programme (UK) facilitates business waste exchanges
- WRAP's business resource efficiency tools help identify symbiosis opportunities

Barriers: Not directly actionable at individual level, Requires business-to-business relationships

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1 kg | Water 10 L | Waste 0.3 kg

25. Build a capsule wardrobe

Difficulty 3 | 120 min | free | global

Edit your wardrobe down to 33 versatile items that mix and match efficiently.

Instructions

- Research the capsule wardrobe concept (Project 333 is a good starting point)
- Audit your wardrobe and set aside items that don't mix well or are rarely worn
- Organise the remaining pieces into coherent outfits

Why it matters: A capsule wardrobe reduces clothing purchases by an estimated 70%, the most impactful sustainable fashion change.

Tips

- Neutral colours maximise mixing potential
- Store off-season clothes separately to make the capsule feel fresh across seasons

Barriers: Lifestyle requiring many different dress codes, Letting go of sentimental items

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1 kg | Water 10 L | Waste 0.3 kg

26. Advocate for deposit return schemes

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Support the expansion of bottle and can deposit return schemes in your region.

Instructions

- Check if your region has a deposit return scheme
- If not, sign a petition or write to your representative supporting one
- If one exists, always use it

Why it matters: Countries with deposit return schemes achieve 90%+ recycling rates for bottles and cans vs. 50-60% without, a proven circular system.

Tips

- Scotland's DRS launched in 2024, the first UK scheme
- CRISP (Campaign for Real Incineration Savings Priorities) advocates for UK DRS

Barriers: Scheme not yet available in your region, Individual influence on policy

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

27. Choose products with recycled content

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

For your next purchase, choose a product made with recycled or reclaimed materials.

Instructions

- Identify something you need to buy
- Research options made with recycled content
- Choose the highest recycled content option

Why it matters: Products with recycled content close the loop, creating demand for recycled material is what makes recycling economically viable.

Tips

- Patagonia fleeces, Adidas Ocean Plastic trainers, and Catapult furniture use recycled content
- Look for certifications like GRS (Global Recycled Standard)

Barriers: Recycled content often costs slightly more, Not always easy to verify claims

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 1 kg | Water 10 L | Waste 0.3 kg

Community (29)

1. Introduce yourself to a neighbour

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Knock on the door of a neighbour you don't know and introduce yourself.

Instructions

- Choose a neighbour you haven't met
- Knock and introduce yourself briefly
- Exchange contact details if it feels right

Why it matters: Connected communities are more resilient to extreme weather events and have lower per-capita resource use through sharing.

Tips

- A small gift (baked goods, garden produce) makes the introduction easier
- Nextdoor app helps connect with local community online first

Barriers: Introversion, Cultural norms around privacy

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

2. Organise a street clean

Difficulty 2 | 60 min | free | global

Pick up litter on your street or organise a group to do it together.

Instructions

- Collect gloves and a bag
- Walk your street picking up litter
- Or use the Keep Britain Tidy app to register a group event

Why it matters: Litter in waterways reaches oceans within days. Community clean-ups are the most effective intervention at the source.

Tips

- Litterpicking groups on Facebook organise across most UK towns
- Councils usually provide free equipment to registered community groups

Barriers: Organising others, Time

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

3. Join a local environmental group

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | free | global

Find and attend a meeting of a local sustainability, conservation, or transition group.

Instructions

- Search Meetup.com or Facebook for local environmental groups
- Register for a meeting or event
- Attend and introduce yourself

Why it matters: Community environmental groups multiply individual impact through collective action and shared skills.

Tips

- Transition Town groups exist in hundreds of cities and towns
- Friends of the Earth local groups run campaigns in most UK areas

Barriers: Time commitment, Finding a group that feels like a fit

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

4. Share surplus garden produce

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Leave surplus fruit, vegetables, or herbs on your front step or a community shelf for neighbours.

Instructions

- Collect any surplus produce from your garden or allotment
- Put out on your front step with a "help yourself" sign
- Or find a local community fridge or sharing shelf

Why it matters: Community food sharing builds social bonds and reduces both food waste and food insecurity simultaneously.

Tips

- Olio app connects local food sharers with people nearby
- Most villages and many urban streets have informal sharing traditions

Barriers: No garden produce to share, Uncertainty about uptake

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

5. Write to your local councillor

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | free | global

Write a letter or email to your local councillor about one local environmental issue.

Instructions

- Identify one local issue: lack of cycle lanes, poor recycling, green space threatened
- Find your councillor's contact details online
- Write a concise, polite letter with one specific ask

Why it matters: Local politicians respond strongly to constituent letters, 10 personalised emails on one issue typically triggers a formal response.

Tips

- WriteToThem.com makes finding and contacting UK councillors simple
- Be specific about the ask, "install cycle lane on X Street" beats "do more for cycling"

Barriers: Uncertainty about how to write formally, Feeling like it won't matter

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

6. Start a community composting group

Difficulty 3 | 60 min | low | global

Propose a shared compost site for your street, block, or community garden.

Instructions

- Check if a community garden or shared greenspace is available
- Propose the idea to neighbours or on Nextdoor
- Apply for a council composting bin grant

Why it matters: Community composting systems handle volumes impossible for individual households and build lasting neighbourhood connections.

Tips

- Many councils offer free compost bins for community groups
- ShareWaste.com maps existing community compost sites, check first

Barriers: Finding suitable land, Ongoing management commitment

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.1 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0.5 kg

7. Attend a local repair café

Difficulty 1 | 120 min | free | global

Visit your nearest repair café and get something fixed, or volunteer your skills.

Instructions

- Find your nearest repair café at repaircafe.org
- Bring a broken item or offer your skills
- Stay for the full session

Why it matters: Repair cafés fix thousands of items per year that would otherwise go to landfill, while building community skills and connections.

Tips

- Even if your item can't be fixed, the skill transfer is valuable
- Skilled volunteers in electronics, textiles, and furniture are most needed

Barriers: Finding the time, Distance to nearest café

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

8. Set up a neighbourhood tool library

Difficulty 3 | 120 min | free | global

Create a shared inventory of tools neighbours can borrow from each other.

Instructions

- Survey neighbours about tools they'd be willing to lend
- Create a shared spreadsheet or use a tool library app
- Agree borrowing terms and circulate to the street

Why it matters: The average drill is used 12 minutes in its lifetime. A street of 20 homes sharing tools could eliminate 19 of 20 purchases.

Tips

- WhatsApp group with a shared list is the simplest system
- ShareTribe can be set up as a free local lending platform

Barriers: Trust with neighbours, Damage liability concerns

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

9. Volunteer at a food bank

Difficulty 2 | 180 min | free | global

Give 3 hours to your local food bank sorting, packing, or distributing donations.

Instructions

- Find your nearest food bank at Trussell Trust or local listings
- Register as a volunteer
- Attend a session and do whatever is needed

Why it matters: UK food banks served 2.99 million emergency food parcels in 2022/23, volunteer hours are their most critical resource.

Tips

- Most food banks need volunteers on weekday mornings
- Sorting donations is approachable for all fitness levels

Barriers: Availability during operating hours, Emotional weight of the role

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

10. Start a Buy Nothing group

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | free | global

Join or start a Buy Nothing group in your neighbourhood for free item sharing.

Instructions

- Search Facebook for "Buy Nothing [your area]"
- Join and post something you want to give away
- Or start a new group if none exists

Why it matters: Buy Nothing groups divert thousands of items from landfill per year while building strong local social networks.

Tips

- Olio is an app-based alternative if a Facebook group doesn't suit
- Groups thrive when everyone contributes, give before you ask

Barriers: Privacy concerns with Facebook, Low participation in new groups

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

11. Teach a sustainability skill

Difficulty 2 | 60 min | free | global

Share a skill you have, composting, mending, cooking from scratch, with a friend or neighbour.

Instructions

- Identify a sustainability skill you're confident in
- Invite one person to learn alongside you
- Demonstrate and let them try

Why it matters: Skill sharing multiplies impact exponentially, one person teaching 10 who each teach 10 reaches 100 people.

Tips

- Informal 1:1 sessions are often more effective than formal workshops
- Filming a short video extends your reach beyond those you can meet in person

Barriers: Imposter syndrome, Finding interested people

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

12. Attend a council meeting on planning

Difficulty 2 | 120 min | free | global

Attend a local council planning or environment committee meeting.

Instructions

- Find the agenda for the next planning committee meeting
- Attend and observe how decisions are made
- Submit a written comment on any relevant planning application

Why it matters: Most planning decisions go unopposed at committee, a single person speaking can shift the outcome on a contentious application.

Tips

- Meeting dates and agendas are public on your council's website
- You can submit a written comment even if you can't attend in person

Barriers: Inconvenient meeting times (often evenings), Complex planning language

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

13. Set up a seed library

Difficulty 2 | 60 min | low | global

Create a small seed-sharing station in your community, a library of saved vegetable seeds.

Instructions

- Collect seed packets you have spare
- Set up a labelled box in a community space, library, or front garden
- Encourage neighbours to take and return seeds

Why it matters: Seed libraries preserve heritage variety diversity and reduce the need for commercially produced seeds.

Tips

- Libraries and community gardens are ideal hosts
 - The Heritage Seed Library preserves thousands of rare varieties
- Barriers:** Finding a community host space, Ongoing management

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

14. Cook for a housebound neighbour

Difficulty 1 | 60 min | low | global

Prepare and deliver a home-cooked meal to an elderly or housebound neighbour.

Instructions

- Identify a neighbour who might benefit
- Cook a double portion of your evening meal
- Deliver and check in on them

Why it matters: Social isolation increases mortality risk by 29%, community connection is as important to health as exercise.

Tips

- Meals on Wheels programmes can connect you formally with people who need regular help
- Even a weekly check-in knock makes a significant difference

Barriers: Not knowing who needs help, Dietary restrictions to navigate

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

15. Plant a community fruit tree

Difficulty 3 | 120 min | low | global

Propose and plant a fruit tree in a shared public space for the whole community to harvest.

Instructions

- Identify suitable public land (park, verge, community garden)
- Get permission from the council or landowner
- Fundraise or use a council grant to buy and plant the tree

Why it matters: Community orchards in urban areas provide free food, carbon sequestration, and biodiversity, and connect neighbours around harvest.

Tips

- The Orchard Project supports community orchard creation across the UK
- Apple, pear, and plum trees are the hardiest and most productive for community settings

Barriers: Planning permission, Long timeline to first harvest

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

16. Sign and share a local climate petition

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Find a local or national climate petition and share it with your network.

Instructions

- Find a petition relevant to your region on Change.org or 38degrees
- Sign and add a personal comment
- Share to social media with a sentence about why it matters to you

Why it matters: Petitions with personal stories are 3× more likely to reach policy makers than those with only signatures.

Tips

- Local council petitions with 1,000+ signatures often trigger a formal debate
- Personalising your share increases sign-up rates from your network by 200%

Barriers: Fatigue with petitions, Uncertainty about effectiveness

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

17. Mentor a young person on sustainability

Difficulty 2 | 60 min | free | global

Spend an hour with a young person sharing knowledge about sustainability or environmental careers.

Instructions

- Connect through a school, youth group, or family network
- Ask what they're curious about
- Share relevant knowledge and resources

Why it matters: Youth mentorship on environmental topics correlates strongly with long-term career choices in green sectors.

Tips

- Many schools welcome external speakers on environmental topics
- Virtual mentoring expands access beyond geography

Barriers: Time, Finding the connection

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

18. Set up a neighbourhood WhatsApp for sustainability

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Create or join a neighbourhood group focused on sharing sustainability tips and resources.

Instructions

- Create a WhatsApp or Signal group for your street
- Invite 5-10 neighbours
- Share one sustainability tip or resource per week

Why it matters: Connected communities share 30% more resources and act collectively on issues more effectively than isolated households.

Tips

- Keep the group focused and low-message to avoid people leaving
- Share practical tips, local events, and swap offers, not news

Barriers: Getting people to join, Group management time

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

19. Donate to a local environmental cause

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | low | global

Make a donation to a local environmental group or community garden.

Instructions

- Find a local environmental group or urban growing project
- Make a one-off donation however small
- Share their work with your network

Why it matters: Local groups often achieve more impact per pound than national charities because they have lower overheads and direct community connection.

Tips

- Local wildlife trusts, community orchards, and repair cafés often have donation pages
- Even £5 per month adds up to meaningful annual support

Barriers: Budget constraints, Finding trustworthy local groups

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

20. Host a sustainability screening

Difficulty 2 | 120 min | free | global

Host a documentary screening at home or in a community space with discussion afterwards.

Instructions

- Choose a documentary: Kiss the Ground, 2040, or Seaspiracy
- Invite friends, family, or neighbours
- Follow with a 20-minute structured discussion

Why it matters: Shared viewing with discussion changes attitudes more powerfully than individual watching, the social element amplifies the message.

Tips

- TOGETHER TUBE lets people watch YouTube videos simultaneously online
- A discussion guide for most environmental documentaries is available from the distributor

Barriers: Getting people to commit to the time, Choosing a film that isn't alienating to a mixed audience

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

21. Participate in your council's budget consultation

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | free | global

Respond to your council's annual budget or service consultation with environmental priorities.

Instructions

- Find your council's current consultation on their website
- Submit a response prioritising green spaces, cycling, and waste services
- Share the consultation with neighbours to amplify input

Why it matters: Councils are legally required to consider consultation responses. Environmental spending is shaped by who responds.

Tips

- Most consultations take 5 minutes online
- Submitting as an individual and as part of a group has double the impact

Barriers: Finding the consultation, Complexity of council budget language

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

22. Grow food with a community garden

Difficulty 2 | 120 min | free | global

Join or volunteer at a community garden or allotment for a session.

Instructions

- Find a community garden near you
- Attend a volunteer day or apply for a plot
- Contribute 2+ hours of work

Why it matters: Community gardens reduce food miles, increase green space, and build social cohesion, they perform better on all sustainability metrics than individual gardens.

Tips

- Many community gardens have waiting lists for plots but welcome volunteers immediately
- Incredible Edible networks exist across the UK, US, and Australia

Barriers: Waiting lists for plots, Distance to the garden

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

23. Share your sustainability journey on social media

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Post honestly about one sustainable change you've made and why it matters to you.

Instructions

- Write a genuine, personal post about one change you've made
- Explain what prompted you and what difference it makes
- Invite others to share their own changes

Why it matters: Peer influence is 3-4× more effective at changing behaviour than expert advice. Your social network trusts you.

Tips

- Honest posts about imperfect progress are more engaging than "I'm perfect" posts
- Instagram and TikTok sustainability communities are large and supportive

Barriers: Privacy concerns, Fear of appearing preachy

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

24. Set up a street library

Difficulty 2 | 60 min | low | global

Install a small weatherproof bookcase on your front fence for neighbours to share books.

Instructions

- Buy or build a weatherproof box
- Install on your fence or front boundary
- Stock with 10 books and add a "take one, leave one" sign

Why it matters: Street libraries reduce book purchases and build community identity, thousands exist globally as Little Free Libraries.

Tips

- Little Free Library charter is free and provides a map listing
- Including children's books maximises usage and community appeal

Barriers: Planning permission in some areas, Ongoing management

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

25. Engage your employer on sustainability

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | free | global

Raise one sustainability improvement suggestion with your employer or HR team.

Instructions

- Identify one change that would reduce your workplace's environmental impact
- Write a one-page proposal with cost and benefit
- Submit to HR, sustainability team, or management

Why it matters: Employees who engage employers on sustainability typically achieve changes that affect hundreds of colleagues, far higher leverage than individual actions.

Tips

- Cost savings are the most persuasive angle for businesses
- Switching to renewable energy, green travel policies, and food waste reduction are the easiest wins

Barriers: No sustainability team to direct it to, Fear of being dismissed

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

26. Join a local litter picking group

Difficulty 1 | 60 min | free | global

Join an organised litter picking session in your area.

Instructions

- Search for "litter picking group [your area]" on Facebook or Meetup
- Register and attend a session
- Bring gloves, tools are usually provided

Why it matters: Litter attracts more litter, cleaned streets stay cleaner 3× longer than uncleaned equivalents.

Tips

- PL3 app lets you log and map litter picks
- Most groups combine the clean with a social element, it's enjoyable

Barriers: Finding an active group, Physical limitations for long walks

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 1 kg

27. Campaign for a 20mph zone in your street

Difficulty 3 | 60 min | free | global

Petition for a 20mph speed limit on your street to improve safety and reduce vehicle emissions.

Instructions

- Collect signatures from neighbours
- Submit a formal request to your local council
- Attend any follow-up consultation meetings

Why it matters: 20mph zones reduce traffic collisions by 40% and encourage cycling and walking, which reduces car use long-term.

Tips

- Living Streets provides free campaign toolkits for 20mph applications
- 10 resident signatures is typically enough to trigger a council feasibility review

Barriers: Neighbour opposition, Long council approval timelines

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

28. Learn about your local MP's climate record

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Research your MP or local politician's voting record on climate and environment issues.

Instructions

- Search "[MP name] climate voting record"
- Use TheyWorkForYou.com for UK MPs
- Note their votes and any public statements on climate

Why it matters: An informed electorate holds politicians accountable, voting for candidates with strong climate records is the highest-leverage democratic action.

Tips

- Climate Coalition rates UK MPs on climate voting
- You can write to your MP about their record, MPs must respond to constituents

Barriers: Frustration with political process, Information overload

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

29. Propose a green commute scheme at work

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | free | global

Suggest a cycle-to-work scheme, shower installation, or transit subsidy to your employer.

Instructions

- Research the Cycle to Work scheme (UK) or equivalent
- Calculate the savings for employees and tax benefits for the employer
- Submit a one-page proposal to HR or finance

Why it matters: Employers who introduce green commuting incentives see a 15-30% shift in how employees travel to work.

Tips

- The Cycle to Work scheme saves employees up to 42% on a bike purchase
- Shower installation costs £1,000-£3,000 but unlocks cycling for many commuters

Barriers: Employer buy-in, No suitable facilities at workplace

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

Social Equity (28)

1. Learn about environmental justice

Difficulty 1 | 30 min | free | global

Read or watch something about how pollution and climate impacts fall hardest on marginalised communities.

Instructions

- Search "environmental justice" and choose one article or short documentary
- Note who is most affected and why
- Reflect on how your own consumption connects to these impacts

Why it matters: Communities of colour and low-income communities are 3× more likely to live near toxic waste sites and bear the worst air pollution burdens.

Tips

- Earthjustice and NRDC have accessible introductions to environmental justice
- Hop Hopkins's writing bridges racial justice and environmentalism powerfully

Barriers: Emotional weight of the subject, Time to engage deeply

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

2. Support a fair trade brand

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | low | global

Buy a Fair Trade certified product, coffee, chocolate, or banana, ensuring farmers receive fair pay.

Instructions

- Look for the Fairtrade Mark on packaging
- Choose one product you buy regularly in its Fair Trade version
- Read about the farming cooperative on the brand's website

Why it matters: Fairtrade farmers receive a minimum price that covers the cost of sustainable production, plus a social premium for community projects.

Tips

- Traidcraft and Equal Exchange are fully Fair Trade businesses
- Supermarket own-brand Fairtrade lines are often the most affordable option

Barriers: Small price premium, Not always available in all stores

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

3. Donate to a climate-vulnerable community

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | low | global

Make a donation to an organisation supporting communities on the frontline of climate impacts.

Instructions

- Research organisations working in climate-vulnerable regions
- Choose one with high accountability scores (GiveWell or Charity Navigator)
- Make a donation however small

Why it matters: The countries contributing least to climate change suffer its worst effects, Pacific islands, sub-Saharan Africa, and low-lying Bangladesh.

Tips

- GiveDirectly sends cash directly to people in climate-impacted communities
- Practical Action focuses on climate adaptation technology for vulnerable communities

Barriers: Budget constraints, Uncertainty about charity effectiveness

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

4. Amplify a marginalised environmental voice

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Share or follow the work of an environmental activist or organisation from a marginalised community.

Instructions

- Search for environmental activists from Global South, indigenous, or BIPOC backgrounds
- Follow one on social media
- Share one of their posts with a genuine comment

Why it matters: Indigenous peoples protect 80% of the world's remaining biodiversity despite comprising only 5% of the global population.

Tips

- Vanessa Nakate, Hindou Oumarou Ibrahim, and Wanjira Mathai are powerful voices
- Follow @IndigenousRising and @WECAN_Intl for ongoing frontline news

Barriers: Not knowing who to follow, Social media fatigue

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

5. Research your supply chain

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | free | global

Trace one product you use back to its origins and the conditions of those who made it.

Instructions

- Choose one product: a phone, clothing item, or food product
- Search "[brand] supply chain transparency" or "[product] labour conditions"
- Find one fact about the workers who produced it

Why it matters: Modern slavery affects 40 million people globally, many in supply chains for electronics, garments, and food we consume daily.

Tips

- Know The Chain benchmarks companies on supply chain transparency
- Fashion Checker rates brands on whether garment workers earn a living wage

Barriers: Deeply complex global supply chains, Lack of brand transparency

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

6. Choose ethical electronics

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | free | global

Research the ethical rating of your next electronics purchase before buying.

Instructions

- Search the brand on Ethical Consumer or Good On You
- Check their cobalt and conflict mineral sourcing policies
- Choose the highest-rated option available

Why it matters: Cobalt mining for batteries uses child labour in DRC mines. Fairphone uses verified cobalt and is the most transparent phone brand.

Tips

- Fairphone is the only phone built for repairability and ethical sourcing
- Extending phone life by 2 years is more impactful than switching brands

Barriers: Limited choice in the market, Price premium for ethical options

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

7. Advocate for green spaces in your area

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | free | global

Research whether local green space access is equitable and advocate for improvements in underserved areas.

Instructions

- Map green spaces in your area and any access gaps
- Identify a neighbourhood with less access than average
- Write to a councillor or sign a petition supporting green space expansion there

Why it matters: Deprived urban areas have 5× less accessible green space than affluent areas, compounding health inequalities.

Tips

- Fields in Trust publishes green space equity data by postcode
- Friends of the Earth's Green Space Index maps access inequality visually

Barriers: Not knowing where the gaps are, Limited political influence

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

8. Learn about climate refugees

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Read about communities already displaced by climate change and what they need.

Instructions

- Search "climate refugees" or "climate displacement" and read one recent article
- Find one organisation supporting climate-displaced people
- Consider a donation or share of their work

Why it matters: By 2050, up to 1.2 billion people could be displaced by climate-related events, the largest forced migration in human history.

Tips

- Internal Displacement Monitoring Centre publishes annual displacement data
- UNHCR Climate Action page covers climate-driven displacement programmes

Barriers: Emotionally difficult topic, Feeling of helplessness

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

9. Support living wage employers

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Choose to spend money at businesses that pay a living wage to all staff.

Instructions

- Search for Living Wage accredited employers in your area
- Prioritise them for your regular spending
- Tell them you chose them because of their accreditation

Why it matters: The Living Wage is calculated on actual cost of living, over 12,000 UK employers are accredited, covering 430,000 workers.

Tips

- LivingWage.org.uk has a directory of accredited employers by sector
- The Real Living Wage is higher than the government's National Living Wage

Barriers: Limited accredited options in some sectors, Cost premium

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

10. Read about food sovereignty

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Learn about food sovereignty movements and the right of communities to control their own food systems.

Instructions

- Search "food sovereignty" and read one article from La Via Campesina or Grain.org
- Note who controls food production in your country
- Reflect on how your food choices connect to this system

Why it matters: Four corporations control 60% of global seed supply, food sovereignty movements fight to return control to farmers.

Tips

- Grain.org publishes accessible reports on corporate control of food systems
- Supporting seed-saving and local farming directly counters corporate concentration

Barriers: Complex political economics involved, Distant from everyday experience

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

11. Volunteer with a migrant support group

Difficulty 2 | 180 min | free | global

Volunteer with an organisation supporting asylum seekers or climate-displaced migrants in your area.

Instructions

- Find a local refugee support organisation
- Register as a volunteer for a specific role
- Attend an induction and your first session

Why it matters: Many asylum seekers come from regions most affected by climate change. Supporting them is a direct act of climate justice.

Tips

- UNHCR Volunteer, Refugees Welcome, and local ESOL groups all need help
- Language tutoring, befriending, and practical support are the most needed skills

Barriers: Time availability, Emotional demands of the work

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

12. Buy from a social enterprise

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | low | global

Make a purchase from a business that reinvests profits into social or environmental good.

Instructions

- Search Social Enterprise UK or Buy Social for businesses in your sector
- Choose one for a purchase you were going to make anyway
- Learn what social mission your purchase supports

Why it matters: Social enterprises trade commercially but prioritise people and planet, they employ marginalised people at 3× the rate of mainstream businesses.

Tips

- Belu water, Divine Chocolate, and Toast Ale are well-known social enterprises
- The Social Enterprise Mark is the equivalent of B Corp for mission-led businesses

Barriers: Not always available for every category, Higher price in some sectors

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

13. Learn about indigenous land rights

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Read about the connection between indigenous land rights and environmental protection.

Instructions

- Read one article about indigenous land stewardship
- Learn about one specific indigenous group defending land in your country or region
- Follow or support an organisation working with them

Why it matters: Indigenous-managed lands contain 80% of the world's biodiversity despite covering only 22% of land surface.

Tips

- Cultural Survival and Amazon Watch cover indigenous land rights globally
- In Australia, AIATSIS maps indigenous country and language groups

Barriers: Limited mainstream coverage, Complex history to engage with

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

14. Consider the climate impact in your vote

Difficulty 1 | 30 min | free | global

Get informed on where parties and candidates stand on climate, whether or not an election is near, so you are ready to factor it into your next vote.

Instructions

- Check when your next local or national election is
- If one is coming up, research each candidate's position on climate and environment
- If no election is near, read about your current representatives' climate record so you are prepared

Why it matters: Government policy changes are the single most powerful lever for systemic climate action, far beyond individual consumer choices.

Tips

- Climate Coalition and Green Alliance rate UK parliamentary candidates
- Vote Climate USA scores American candidates on climate action

Barriers: Other priorities in the vote, Candidate positions unclear or weak across all parties

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

15. Reduce your plastic use in solidarity with ocean-dependent communities

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Learn about fishing communities affected by ocean plastic and reduce one plastic source in your life.

Instructions

- Read one article about plastic impact on fishing communities
- Identify one single-use plastic in your daily routine
- Replace it with a reusable alternative

Why it matters: Ocean plastic costs fishing communities \$13 billion per year in lost catch and damaged equipment.

Tips

- Ghost gear (lost fishing nets) accounts for 46% of ocean plastic by weight
- World Oceans Day (June 8) has resources on fishing community impact

Barriers: Connection feeling remote, Already doing what's possible

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

16. Learn about energy poverty

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Research energy poverty in your country and what policies address it.

Instructions

- Search "energy poverty [your country]"
- Note how many households are affected and why
- Find one charity or policy initiative addressing it

Why it matters: 3 billion people still cook with solid fuels like wood and charcoal, causing 4 million deaths per year from indoor air pollution.

Tips

- National Energy Action (UK) and Energy Action Scotland work on fuel poverty
- Clean cooking solutions are among the highest-impact climate interventions globally

Barriers: Feeling distant from the issue, Complex policy landscape

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

17. Support a community energy project

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | low | global

Find a community-owned renewable energy project and invest or donate.

Instructions

- Search "community energy [your area]"
- Find a local community solar or wind project
- Invest or donate to support it

Why it matters: Community energy projects keep financial returns local, reduce energy costs for members, and build democratic ownership of clean energy.

Tips

- Community Energy England lists all UK community energy projects
- Abundance Generation and Ethex offer community energy investment platforms

Barriers: Minimum investment thresholds, Not available in all areas

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

18. Choose a diverse supply chain brand

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Find and buy from a brand that explicitly works with women-owned or minority-owned suppliers.

Instructions

- Search "women-owned brand [product category]"
- Verify the claim on their website
- Make a purchase you would have made anyway

Why it matters: Women farmers produce 60-80% of food in many developing countries but own only 10-20% of land, fair trade and gender-focused sourcing addresses this imbalance.

Tips

- Equal Exchange explicitly sources from women-farmer cooperatives
- WEConnect International certifies women-owned businesses globally

Barriers: Not always a clear option in every category, Greenwashing risk

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

19. Donate unwanted clothing to a refugee charity

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Donate clean, good-condition clothing directly to a refugee or homelessness charity.

Instructions

- Sort clothes you no longer wear
- Find a refugee or homelessness charity accepting donations
- Drop off or arrange a collection

Why it matters: Charities like Refugees Welcome and Mustard Seed match clothing directly to people in need, far more impactful than general charity shops.

Tips

- Clothing banks at supermarkets go to profit-making companies, donate directly to charities instead
- Call ahead to check current needs, some items are more needed than others

Barriers: Finding a direct charity near you, Transport for larger donations

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

20. Speak up against environmental racism

Difficulty 2 | 20 min | free | global

If you hear or see a decision that places environmental burdens on marginalised communities, speak up.

Instructions

- Learn to recognise environmental racism in planning decisions
- When you encounter one, write to the council or sign a petition opposing it
- Share the issue with your network

Why it matters: Incinerators, waste facilities, and polluting industries are disproportionately sited in low-income and minority communities in almost every country studied.

Tips

- Friends of the Earth's 'A Fairer, Greener Britain' report maps environmental inequality in the UK
- Earthjustice tracks environmental justice cases in the US

Barriers: Identifying the issue in the first place, Not feeling qualified to speak

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

21. Reduce meat in solidarity with land rights

Difficulty 1 | 5 min | free | global

Connect your meat reduction to the reality that cattle ranching drives deforestation and indigenous land loss.

Instructions

- Choose one meat-free meal today
- Read one article linking beef production to Amazon land rights violations
- Share what you learned with one other person

Why it matters: Amazon deforestation for cattle is directly linked to the murder of indigenous land defenders, over 200 were killed in 2022 alone.

Tips

- Global Witness publishes annual reports on land defender killings
- Reducing beef from Brazilian supply chains is most effective, check meat origin labels

Barriers: Supply chain opacity on meat origin, Diet preferences

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

22. Learn a phrase in an indigenous language

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Learn one word or phrase in an indigenous language from your region as an act of cultural respect.

Instructions

- Research indigenous peoples of your region
- Find one learning resource for their language
- Learn a greeting or word for nature

Why it matters: Of 7,000 languages spoken today, 3,000 are endangered, mostly indigenous languages that carry unique ecological knowledge.

Tips

- First Voices (Canada) and AIATSIS (Australia) host indigenous language learning resources
- Acknowledging country in your own language is a meaningful first step

Barriers: Language learning difficulty, Not knowing which indigenous group is local

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

23. Sign up for a community supported agriculture scheme

Difficulty 2 | 20 min | low | global

Join a CSA box scheme that pays local farmers fairly and builds direct food community connection.

Instructions

- Search "CSA box scheme [your area]" or "veg box local farmers"
- Sign up for a trial box
- Cook one meal entirely from the box contents

Why it matters: CSA schemes guarantee farmers income in advance, enabling them to farm sustainably without the financial pressure that drives agrochemical overuse.

Tips

- Soil Association's Organic Farm Box lists UK CSA schemes
- Open Food Network connects buyers directly with local farmers in many countries

Barriers: Fixed weekly boxes don't suit variable households, Cost compared to supermarket

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

24. Audit your workplace for inclusion in sustainability

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | free | global

Check whether your workplace's sustainability programme includes and benefits all staff equitably.

Instructions

- Review your company's sustainability or CSR policy
- Identify whether it addresses workers in the supply chain, not just office recycling
- Raise any gaps with the sustainability or HR team

Why it matters: Most corporate sustainability programmes focus on Scope 1 and 2 emissions while ignoring Scope 3 supply chain labour impacts.

Tips

- The UN SDGs provide a framework for comprehensive business sustainability
- Ask specifically about living wage in the supply chain, a key gap in most programmes

Barriers: No sustainability programme exists yet, Resistance from management

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

25. Support water access for all

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | low | global

Donate to an organisation providing clean water access to communities without it.

Instructions

- Research Water Aid, charity: water, or a similar organisation
- Make a donation of whatever amount you can
- Share their work on social media

Why it matters: 2.2 billion people lack access to safely managed drinking water, a crisis driven by climate change, inequality, and infrastructure gaps.

Tips

- Charity: water publishes GPS coordinates for every project they fund, full transparency
- Water Aid has been independently rated one of the most effective development charities

Barriers: Budget constraints, Feeling that donating isn't enough

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

26. Oppose greenwashing

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Identify and report one instance of corporate greenwashing you encounter.

Instructions

- Notice any environmental claim that seems vague or misleading
- Check it against the ASA or FTC greenwashing guidelines
- Report to the advertising regulator or share publicly with evidence

Why it matters: Greenwashing misleads consumers and diverts spending from genuinely sustainable products, the ASA banned Shell and HSBC adverts in 2022 for it.

Tips

- The ASA (UK) and FTC (US) both accept greenwashing complaints online
- Terms like "eco", "green", "sustainable" are unregulated, look for third-party certification instead

Barriers: Complexity of what counts as greenwashing, Uncertainty about where to report

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

27. Choose green finance

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | free | global

Move savings or investments away from institutions funding fossil fuels toward ethical alternatives.

Instructions

- Check your savings institution at BankTrack.org or FossilFreeIndexes.com
- Research ethical savings accounts in your country
- Open an account with a higher-rated institution

Why it matters: Every £1 saved in a fossil-fuel-funding bank finances approximately £7 of fossil fuel lending. Ethical banking is the highest per-person financial lever.

Tips

- Ecology Building Society and Triodos Bank are leading UK ethical options
- In the US, Amalgamated Bank and Clean Energy Credit Unions are fossil-free

Barriers: Lower rates in some ethical products, Switching inertia

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

28. Attend a climate justice event

Difficulty 2 | 120 min | free | global

Attend a climate justice rally, march, or public meeting, or, if none is on right now, learn from affected communities online instead.

Instructions

- Look for an upcoming climate justice event near you
- If one is on, attend and listen to speakers from affected communities
- If not, watch a recorded talk or follow a frontline organisation and learn from their work

Why it matters: Climate justice events connect the environmental and social movements, building the broader coalitions needed for systemic change.

Tips

- Global Climate Strike events take place in hundreds of cities each year
- XR, Green New Deal Rising, and Stop Cambo have different approaches, find one that resonates

Barriers: Location and timing, Political discomfort

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

Climate Advocacy (28)

1. Write to your MP or representative

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | free | global

Write a personal letter to your elected representative about one specific climate policy.

Instructions

- Find your representative's contact details
- Choose one specific policy ask (net zero targets, EV charging, insulation grants)
- Write a short, personal letter, 3 paragraphs maximum

Why it matters: A personalised letter is worth approximately 100 form emails to an MP, they are legally obliged to respond to constituents.

Tips

- WriteToThem.com makes finding and contacting UK representatives simple
- One specific ask is far more effective than a list of demands

Barriers: Uncertainty about what to write, Feeling like it won't make a difference

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

2. Join a climate advocacy organisation

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Become a member or sign up to volunteer with a climate advocacy group.

Instructions

- Research advocacy groups operating in your area
- Sign up as a member or volunteer
- Attend a first meeting or action

Why it matters: Collective advocacy is 100-1000× more effective per person than individual lifestyle changes at driving systemic policy change.

Tips

- Friends of the Earth, 350.org, and Extinction Rebellion operate globally
- Climate Emergency UK coordinates a broad coalition of UK groups

Barriers: Time commitment, Finding a group that fits your values and approach

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

3. Attend a climate march

Difficulty 1 | 120 min | free | global

Join the next climate march or rally near you, or, if none is scheduled right now, follow a movement so you hear about the next one.

Instructions

- Search for upcoming climate marches or rallies in your area
- If one is coming up, register or simply show up, and bring a friend
- If none is scheduled, follow a climate group or watch a recorded rally or talk to stay engaged

Why it matters: Mass mobilisation events shift political will, the UK's 2019 climate marches contributed directly to the government's 2050 net zero commitment.

Tips

- Bring water, comfortable shoes, and a sign if you have something specific to say
- Marching with others builds motivation and personal commitment to the cause

Barriers: Location and timing, Mobility or health limitations

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

4. Talk to someone about climate change

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | free | global

Have an honest, open conversation with a friend or family member about climate change.

Instructions

- Choose someone who doesn't usually talk about climate
- Start with a question, not a lecture
- Listen as much as you speak

Why it matters: Conversations with trusted people are the single most effective way to shift attitudes, far more powerful than media or advertising.

Tips

- Climate Outreach's "Talk about Climate" guide has evidence-based conversation strategies
- Starting with shared values (family, local nature, economy) is more effective than starting with facts

Barriers: Conflict avoidance, Not knowing how to start

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

5. Post a climate fact to social media

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Share one verified climate fact or personal climate action on social media.

Instructions

- Find a compelling climate fact from IPCC, NASA, or Our World in Data
- Write a personal, accessible post, not just a retweet
- Invite responses with a question at the end

Why it matters: Social media posts from trusted individuals are 4× more likely to change attitudes than posts from media organisations or governments.

Tips

- Our World in Data has ready-made, accurate climate graphics
- Personal narrative ("I changed X and here's what I noticed") outperforms data-only posts

Barriers: Fear of being trolled, Not knowing what to say

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

6. Respond to a climate consultation

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | free | global

Respond to an open government or council consultation on a climate policy, or, if none is open now, read up on a current climate policy so you are ready when one opens.

Instructions

- Check for open consultations at your national or local government
- If one is open, read the proposals, form a view, and submit a response, even a short one counts
- If none is open, read one current climate policy proposal and note where you stand

Why it matters: Consultation responses directly inform policy, government departments are required to report on the volume and content of responses received.

Tips

- Consult.justice.gov.uk (UK) and regulations.gov (US) list all open consultations
- Climate-related consultations often receive few responses, yours will stand out

Barriers: Complex technical language, Time to read and respond

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

7. Share your carbon footprint calculation

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Calculate and publicly share your personal carbon footprint to normalise the conversation.

Instructions

- Calculate your footprint at WWF, CarbonFootprint.com, or similar
- Note the result and which areas are highest
- Share on social media with one thing you'll do to reduce it

Why it matters: Sharing carbon footprints normalises the conversation and creates peer accountability, one of the most effective behaviour-change mechanisms.

Tips

- WWF's footprint calculator takes 5 minutes and gives a breakdown by category
- Sharing imperfect results is more credible and more engaging than perfection

Barriers: Embarrassment about high footprint, Privacy concerns

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

8. Call out greenwashing publicly

Difficulty 2 | 20 min | free | global

Publicly call out a misleading environmental claim from a company.

Instructions

- Identify a vague or misleading green claim in an advert or product
- Post about it with the specific misleading claim and why
- Tag the brand and relevant media or regulatory accounts

Why it matters: Public pressure has successfully resulted in advertising bans for Shell, HSBC, and Ryanair in the UK, all driven by public complaints.

Tips

- Screenshot the ad as evidence before posting
- Tag the ASA (UK) or FTC (US) alongside the brand

Barriers: Legal concern about defamation (stick to facts), Social media backlash

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

9. Support climate journalism

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | low | global

Subscribe to or donate to independent climate journalism.

Instructions

- Find a climate-focused outlet: Carbon Brief, Drilled, Inside Climate News
- Subscribe or donate
- Share one of their articles with your network

Why it matters: Independent climate journalism holds corporations and governments accountable, and is chronically underfunded compared to fossil fuel PR budgets.

Tips

- Carbon Brief is free and the UK's most authoritative climate site
- DeSmog investigates climate misinformation campaigns from PR firms

Barriers: Subscription cost, Already consuming enough news

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

10. Use your professional skills for climate

Difficulty 2 | 60 min | free | global

Offer your professional expertise pro bono to a climate organisation for one project.

Instructions

- Identify a skill you have: design, legal, finance, IT, marketing, writing
- Find a climate organisation that needs that skill
- Offer one day or project of pro bono support

Why it matters: Climate organisations are vastly under-resourced in professional skills, one day of skilled pro bono work can deliver more value than a year of donations.

Tips

- Catchafire matches professionals with nonprofits by skill
- Lawyers for Climate and Comms Declare are sector-specific networks

Barriers: Finding the right organisation, Work commitments

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

11. Engage your faith community on climate

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | free | global

If you are part of a faith community, raise the topic of climate stewardship with a leader or in a meeting.

Instructions

- Identify an opportunity to raise climate within your faith context
- Connect to theological or ethical principles your community shares
- Propose one practical action: solar panels, plant-based meal, carbon footprint audit

Why it matters: Faith communities represent billions of people globally, their engagement is a key lever for mass behaviour and policy change.

Tips

- Operation Noah (Christian), Islamic Foundation for Ecology, and Jewish Climate Action network offer resources
- Framing as stewardship is effective across all faith traditions

Barriers: Not part of a faith community, Reluctance to mix religion and politics

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

12. Write a letter to the editor

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | free | global

Write a letter to a newspaper editor in response to a recent climate story.

Instructions

- Find a recent climate story in a local or national paper
- Write a short letter (150-200 words) adding evidence or a personal perspective
- Submit to the letters editor

Why it matters: Letters to the editor reach tens of thousands of readers and signal to editors that climate stories generate engagement.

Tips

- Keep it short, most papers print letters under 200 words
- Personal experience is more powerful than statistics in letters

Barriers: Writing confidence, Low publication probability

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

13. Divest your pension from fossil fuels

Difficulty 3 | 60 min | free | global

Contact your pension provider and request divestment from fossil fuels or a switch to a sustainable fund.

Instructions

- Get your pension details and find the investment policy
- Write to the fund manager requesting a fossil-fuel-free option
- Switch your contributions to a sustainable fund if one exists

Why it matters: Global divestment campaigns have caused \$40 trillion of assets to be committed to divesting from fossil fuels, one of the largest financial movements in history.

Tips

- Make My Money Matter has template letters for UK pension divestment requests
- NEST, Peoples Pension, and Aviva all now offer sustainable fund options

Barriers: Pension complexity, Fear of financial performance impact

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

14. Challenge a fossil fuel advert

Difficulty 2 | 15 min | free | global

Report a fossil fuel company advert to the advertising standards authority.

Instructions

- Find a fossil fuel advert making environmental claims
- Check it against ASA greenwashing guidelines
- Submit a complaint with specific evidence

Why it matters: The ASA upheld complaints against Shell, Ryanair, and HSBC in 2022-23 following systematic public pressure campaigns.

Tips

- Complaints are more likely to succeed when submitted in numbers, coordinate with others
- Badvertising tracks and publishes fossil fuel advertising for complaint coordination

Barriers: Complaint process complexity, Low individual complaint success rate

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

15. Register to vote and vote on climate

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Make sure you are registered to vote, then, whether or not an election is near, learn one climate policy so you are ready to vote on climate when the time comes.

Instructions

- Check your voter registration (e.g. gov.uk/register-to-vote in the UK or vote.gov in the US) and register if needed
- If an election is coming up, research each party or candidate's climate policy
- If no election is near, read up on one climate policy or your representative's climate record so you are ready

Why it matters: Voter turnout on climate-related elections is the single most powerful individual democratic action available.

Tips

- Climate Coalition publishes a non-partisan climate policy comparison before each election
- Tactical voting calculators help climate-focused voters in first-past-the-post systems

Barriers: Electoral registration deadline, Apathy about political effectiveness

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

16. Speak at a public meeting

Difficulty 3 | 60 min | free | global

Find and speak at a local public meeting about a climate-related issue.

Instructions

- Find a local council, planning, or community meeting with a climate dimension
- Register to speak (most meetings allow 3 minutes public speaking)
- Prepare a short, personal, specific statement

Why it matters: Public speakers at council meetings carry disproportionate influence, a single articulate contribution can shift committee votes.

Tips

- Council meetings list speakers on their website the day before
- Focus on one specific issue rather than the full breadth of climate change

Barriers: Public speaking anxiety, Finding meetings open to public contribution

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

17. Organise a film screening for advocacy

Difficulty 2 | 120 min | free | global

Host a climate film screening as an advocacy and community-building event.

Instructions

- Choose a film with an action message: 2040, Kiss the Ground, or Seaspiracy
- Invite a wider community group, not just existing climate activists
- Facilitate a structured discussion linking the film to local action

Why it matters: Film screenings with discussion have been shown to shift climate attitudes more than almost any other format, particularly for people new to the issue.

Tips

- ParkRun climate events, churches, community halls, and workplaces are good venues
- The discussion is the most important part, plan questions in advance

Barriers: Organising attendance, Venue cost

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

18. Read the IPCC summary for policymakers

Difficulty 2 | 60 min | free | global

Read the latest IPCC Summary for Policymakers to understand the scientific consensus on climate.

Instructions

- Download the latest IPCC Assessment Report Summary for Policymakers at [ipcc.ch](https://www.ipcc.ch)
- Read with a notepad, note key findings and their certainty levels
- Share one finding that surprised you

Why it matters: The IPCC SPM is the most authoritative climate science document in the world, understanding it makes you an informed advocate.

Tips

- The IPCC produces a new assessment every 5-7 years, look for the most recent AR6
- Climate science communication experts translate it into accessible language at CarbonBrief.org

Barriers: Dense technical language, Length and volume of material

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

19. Connect with your local climate group online

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Find and follow a local climate action group on social media or join their mailing list.

Instructions

- Search Facebook or Meetup for climate groups in your area
- Follow or join at least one
- Engage with one of their posts or events

Why it matters: Local climate groups are the connective tissue between individual action and systemic change, finding your community is a crucial step.

Tips

- Transition Town groups, local Friends of the Earth, and Climate Action groups all operate locally
- Most groups are welcoming to new members at any level of knowledge or commitment

Barriers: Social anxiety about new groups, Low activity in very rural areas

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

20. Support a climate legal case

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | low | global

Donate to or share a climate litigation case challenging a government or corporation.

Instructions

- Find an active climate legal case (ClientEarth, Earthjustice, or national equivalents)
- Read the basis of the case
- Donate or share to raise awareness

Why it matters: Climate litigation has successfully halted pipelines, coal plants, and airport expansions globally, it's the fastest-growing climate strategy.

Tips

- ClientEarth has won landmark cases against Shell and major banks in Europe
- Youth-led cases (Juliana v. USA, Urgenda, Sacchi v. Argentina) have set legal precedents

Barriers: Complexity of understanding legal cases, Indirect connection to action

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

21. Talk to a child about climate in a hopeful way

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | free | global

Have an age-appropriate conversation with a child about climate change, focusing on what people are doing about it.

Instructions

- Choose a child you know, niece, neighbour, child
- Start with something positive: solar panels, rewilding, electric cars
- Answer questions honestly, with optimism where genuine

Why it matters: Children who understand climate and feel agency about it grow into adults who vote, advocate, and career-choose around it.

Tips

- CAFOD and WWF have age-appropriate climate resources for children
- Focus on solutions and local action, avoid catastrophising for under-12s

Barriers: Finding the right balance between honesty and hope, Child's anxiety if they've already heard frightening things

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

22. Advocate for better cycling infrastructure

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | free | global

Write to your council or transport authority about a missing cycling link or road safety concern.

Instructions

- Identify a gap or danger point in your local cycling network
- Write to the relevant transport authority with a specific ask
- Share the issue with a local cycling campaign group to amplify

Why it matters: Safe cycling infrastructure increases cycling rates by 100-500%, the most cost-effective transport decarbonisation investment available.

Tips

- CycleStreets and Strava Heatmap show where cyclists already want to ride
- Cycling UK and local cycling campaigns can add organisational weight to your request

Barriers: Long council response timelines, Complex infrastructure planning processes

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

23. Pressure your pension fund in writing

Difficulty 2 | 20 min | free | global

Write formally to your pension fund trustee requesting climate disclosure and net zero commitments.

Instructions

- Find your pension fund's contact address
- Write requesting: net zero target, fossil fuel divestment timeline, and TCFD compliance
- Share your letter via Make My Money Matter to amplify

Why it matters: Pension funds with engaged members are 3× more likely to adopt climate resolutions, your written request carries legal weight as a beneficiary.

Tips

- Make My Money Matter has a template letter covering all key asks
- TPR (The Pensions Regulator) requires pension trustees to address climate risk under law

Barriers: Complex financial language, Response time is slow

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

24. Join a divestment campaign

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Add your voice to an active fossil fuel divestment campaign targeting a specific institution.

Instructions

- Find an active divestment campaign targeting a university, council, or fund
- Sign the petition or join the campaign group
- Share via social media with a personal statement

Why it matters: The global divestment movement has committed \$40 trillion in assets, starting with small campaign wins at individual institutions.

Tips

- Fossil Free UK and 350.org run active campaigns targeting specific institutions
- University campaigns are particularly accessible for students and alumni

Barriers: No active campaign in your area, Institutional resistance

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

25. Run a workplace climate challenge

Difficulty 3 | 60 min | free | global

Organise a 30-day sustainability challenge for your workplace or team.

Instructions

- Propose the challenge to your manager or sustainability team
- Create a simple tracking mechanism, shared spreadsheet or app
- Launch with a kick-off session and close with results and prizes

Why it matters: Workplace challenges create peer accountability and achieve 30-50% more behaviour change than individual pledges alone.

Tips

- The Carbon Literacy Project offers certified workplace carbon literacy training
- EcoAct and Anthesis run corporate sustainability challenge programmes

Barriers: Management buy-in, Staff time and engagement

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

26. Follow a climate scientist

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Follow at least one climate scientist or researcher on social media to keep informed.

Instructions

- Search for climate scientists on X/Twitter or LinkedIn
- Choose one whose communication style you appreciate
- Engage with and share their posts

Why it matters: Direct communication from scientists increases public trust in climate information, social media has made scientists accessible in a new way.

Tips

- Katharine Hayhoe, Michael Mann, and Ed Hawkins communicate climate science accessibly
- NASA and NOAA accounts post data visualisations that are shareable and accurate

Barriers: Social media fatigue, Difficulty assessing credibility

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

27. Participate in a climate survey or research

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Respond to a climate attitudes survey or academic research study.

Instructions

- Find a climate survey from an academic institution or reputable NGO
- Complete it honestly and fully
- Share the opportunity with friends to increase the sample

Why it matters: Climate attitudes research informs communication strategy, knowing what people actually think and fear enables more effective campaigns.

Tips

- Climate Outreach, Grantham Institute, and Yale Program on Climate Change Communication run regular surveys
- Participating in longitudinal studies is especially valuable, look for multi-year studies

Barriers: Privacy concerns, Survey length

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

28. Run for local office on a green platform

Difficulty 3 | 180 min | free | global

Research what it takes to stand as a local councillor and consider doing so.

Instructions

- Research the requirements to stand in your local elections
- Attend a council meeting to understand the environment
- Contact the Green Party, Labour, or an independent candidacy group to learn how to stand

Why it matters: Local councillors make decisions affecting hundreds of thousands of tonnes of CO₂, planning, transport, housing, and energy are all local government functions.

Tips

- Most parties welcome new candidates with environmental focus
- Even standing and losing raises the profile of environmental issues in your ward

Barriers: Time commitment, Fear of public scrutiny

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

Wellbeing (28)

1. Spend 20 minutes in nature

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Step outside and spend 20 minutes in a natural setting with no phone.

Instructions

- Go to a park, garden, or greenspace
- Leave your phone in your pocket or at home
- Walk slowly and observe, trees, sounds, light

Why it matters: 20 minutes in nature reduces cortisol (stress hormone) by 21%, one of the most evidence-based wellbeing interventions available.

Tips

- Even sitting under a tree counts
- The 3-3-3 rule: name 3 things you see, hear, and can touch

Barriers: No greenspace nearby, Weather

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

2. Try meat-free for a week for your health

Difficulty 2 | 30 min | low | global

Go meat-free for 7 days, a wellbeing challenge as much as an environmental one.

Instructions

- Plan 7 days of plant-based meals
- Track energy levels, digestion, and mood
- Note both what you enjoyed and what you found difficult

Why it matters: Plant-based diets are associated with lower rates of heart disease, type 2 diabetes, and certain cancers, as well as 50-70% lower CO₂ emissions.

Tips

- Legumes, tofu, tempeh, and eggs are excellent protein sources
- Most people report improved energy and digestion within 3-4 days

Barriers: Cravings, Social eating complexity, Family preferences

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

3. Walk barefoot on grass or soil

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Walk barefoot on natural ground for at least 15 minutes.

Instructions

- Find a safe patch of grass, sand, or earth
- Remove shoes and walk slowly
- Focus on the sensation of each step

Why it matters: Earthing (grounding) reduces inflammation markers and improves sleep quality according to multiple peer-reviewed studies.

Tips

- Morning dew on grass is especially pleasant in summer
- Check first for hazards, glass, thorns

Barriers: No safe outdoor space, Temperature extremes

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

4. Plant something and watch it grow

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | low | global

Plant a seed or seedling and commit to caring for it daily.

Instructions

- Buy a simple seed, cress, radish, or basil
- Plant in a small pot or cup
- Water daily and observe

Why it matters: Caring for plants reduces anxiety by 37% and increases feelings of competence and nurturing, proven in multiple horticultural therapy trials.

Tips

- Cress germinates in 3 days, instant gratification
- Growing food adds purpose and connection to nature simultaneously

Barriers: Forgetting to water, No sunny spot

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

5. Have a screen-free evening

Difficulty 2 | 180 min | free | global

Spend an entire evening without screens, no TV, phone, or laptop.

Instructions

- Put devices in another room from 6pm
- Plan an alternative: read, cook, walk, call a friend, play music
- Note how you feel at 9pm vs. a normal screen evening

Why it matters: Screen-free evenings improve sleep quality by 30% and reduce anxiety scores by 15% in consistent studies.

Tips

- Inform your household so they're not confused by unresponsive devices
- Have your activity planned before starting, decision fatigue leads to reaching for phones

Barriers: Missing important messages, Habit of filling time with screens

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

6. Cook a slow, intentional meal

Difficulty 2 | 90 min | low | global

Cook a meal from scratch without rushing, treat the process as the activity, not just the outcome.

Instructions

- Choose a recipe you find enjoyable to cook
- Put on music or a podcast
- Cook without multitasking, be present in the process

Why it matters: Mindful cooking reduces stress, increases gratitude, and produces meals with 30% less waste than hurried cooking.

Tips

- Slow-cooked dishes are the easiest to cook mindfully, they run on their own
- Cooking as meditation is a real practice, Google "mindful cooking" for guidance

Barriers: Time, Cooking anxiety

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

7. Keep a gratitude journal for a week

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Write three things you're grateful for each morning, focusing on nature, connection, and experiences.

Instructions

- Get a notebook or use an app
- Write 3 things you're grateful for each morning
- Include at least one thing connected to the natural world

Why it matters: Gratitude journalling for 7 days increases life satisfaction scores by 10% and reduces material desire, a direct pathway to sustainable consumption.

Tips

- Be specific, "morning light through the trees" beats "nature"
- Review past entries on difficult days for a mood lift

Barriers: Forgetting, Feeling the exercise is meaningless

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

8. Bake bread from scratch

Difficulty 2 | 180 min | low | global

Bake a loaf of bread without a bread machine, hands in dough, no shortcuts.

Instructions

- Find a simple white or wholemeal bread recipe
- Knead by hand for 10 minutes
- Allow to prove and bake, share the result

Why it matters: Bread-making is one of the most reliably meditative activities, the physical process of kneading reduces cortisol measurably.

Tips

- Dan Lepard's "Short and Sweet" has the most reliable beginner recipes
- Sourdough takes 3 days, start with a simple yeast loaf

Barriers: Time, Oven access, Fear of failure

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

9. Do a digital detox for a day

Difficulty 2 | 10 min | free | global

Go a full day with no social media and minimal digital device use.

Instructions

- Delete or log out of social media apps
- Put your phone on silent with only calls allowed
- Fill the day with analogue activities

Why it matters: One day of reduced social media reduces loneliness and anxiety markers by 15-20%, with effects persisting for up to a week.

Tips

- Announce it to close contacts so they know to call rather than message
- Leave your phone at home for walks, it's surprisingly liberating

Barriers: Work requiring digital access, Anxiety about missing something

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

10. Make time for a hobby that uses your hands

Difficulty 1 | 60 min | free | global

Spend an hour on a hands-on hobby: knitting, woodworking, drawing, pottery, or gardening.

Instructions

- Choose a hands-on activity you enjoy or want to try
- Set aside one uninterrupted hour
- Resist the urge to listen to anything, just be in the activity

Why it matters: Hand-use activities activate the parasympathetic nervous system, the body's rest state, reducing stress hormones within 20 minutes.

Tips

- Knitting on public transport is a growing trend, productive calm in commuting time
- YouTube tutorials make any craft accessible to beginners

Barriers: Not knowing which craft to try, Feeling it's wasteful to start a new hobby without completing the last

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

11. Swim in open water

Difficulty 2 | 60 min | free | global

Swim in a lake, river, or sea safely, a full reset for the nervous system.

Instructions

- Find a safe open water swimming spot
- Go with a friend for safety
- Start with a short dip, temperature shock passes within 30 seconds

Why it matters: Open water swimming reduces depression and anxiety symptoms as effectively as antidepressants in small trial studies.

Tips

- Outdoor Swimming Society maps safe swimming spots in the UK
- A wetsuit extends the viable season and reduces shock significantly

Barriers: Safety in open water, Water quality in some areas, Temperature

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

12. Eat lunch outside today

Difficulty 1 | 30 min | free | global

Take your lunch break outside and eat it without looking at a screen.

Instructions

- Prepare your lunch to take outside
- Find a bench, lawn, or outdoor space
- Eat slowly without a phone or device

Why it matters: Lunchtime nature exposure improves afternoon concentration by 20% and reduces stress hormones.

Tips

- Even a building doorstep or fire escape counts as "outside"
- Do this on difficult days especially, it breaks the anxious rumination cycle

Barriers: Bad weather, No outdoor space near workplace, Short lunch breaks

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

13. Practise a breathing exercise

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Try box breathing or 4-7-8 breathing for 10 minutes to reset your stress response.

Instructions

- Find a quiet place to sit comfortably
- Try box breathing: inhale 4 counts, hold 4, exhale 4, hold 4
- Repeat for 10 minutes

Why it matters: Controlled breathing activates the vagus nerve and reduces cortisol, the mechanism behind yoga, meditation, and singing.

Tips

- The Wim Hof Method and Andrew Huberman's physiological sigh are evidence-based protocols
- 4-7-8 breathing (inhale 4, hold 7, exhale 8) is particularly effective for anxiety

Barriers: Restless mind, Difficulty sitting still

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

14. Sleep with no artificial light

Difficulty 1 | 10 min | free | global

Make your bedroom completely dark tonight for a full night's sleep.

Instructions

- Cover or remove all standby lights, chargers, and devices
- Use a blackout blind or heavy curtains
- Put your phone face-down in another room or set to airplane mode

Why it matters: Even small amounts of artificial light during sleep reduce melatonin production by 50%, impairing sleep quality and immune function.

Tips

- Eye masks are an effective alternative to blackout curtains
- Red nightlights are the least disruptive to melatonin if total darkness isn't possible

Barriers: Streetlights outside window, Partner preferences

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

15. Take a cold shower

Difficulty 2 | 10 min | free | global

End your shower with 30-60 seconds of cold water.

Instructions

- Shower as normal
- Turn the temperature to cold for the final 30-60 seconds
- Breathe steadily, the shock passes in 10 seconds

Why it matters: Cold exposure increases dopamine by 250%, a lasting mood elevation lasting 2-4 hours that reduces reliance on stimulants.

Tips

- Start with just 10 seconds and build up each day
- Cold water after exercise reduces DOMS (muscle soreness) by 30%

Barriers: Initial shock, Cold climate making it particularly unpleasant

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

16. Read a physical book for an hour

Difficulty 1 | 60 min | free | global

Read a physical book, not a screen, for one full uninterrupted hour.

Instructions

- Choose a book from your shelf you haven't finished
- Sit in a comfortable spot
- Read without a device within reach

Why it matters: Reading physical books for 6 minutes reduces stress by 68%, faster than a walk, music, or tea.

Tips

- Library loans make physical books free and zero-waste
- A physical book before bed improves sleep quality vs. e-readers

Barriers: Difficulty concentrating, No accessible library nearby

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

17. Do a body scan meditation

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Follow a body scan guided meditation to connect with physical sensation.

Instructions

- Find a free body scan on YouTube or Insight Timer
- Lie down in a quiet place
- Follow the guidance for 15-20 minutes

Why it matters: Body scan meditation reduces physical pain perception by 40% and is a primary treatment in Mindfulness-Based Stress Reduction (MBSR) programmes.

Tips

- Jon Kabat-Zinn's guided body scan is the most widely used version
- Insight Timer has hundreds of free body scans in different lengths

Barriers: Falling asleep, Restless mind

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

18. Cook and eat a seasonal, plant-based feast

Difficulty 2 | 120 min | low | global

Prepare an elaborate plant-based meal using only seasonal ingredients, and eat it with care.

Instructions

- Research seasonal vegetables for your region today
- Design a simple 2-course plant-based meal around them
- Cook slowly and eat without screens

Why it matters: Seasonal, plant-based eating is associated with higher reported life satisfaction, connecting pleasure, health, and environmental values simultaneously.

Tips

- Ottolenghi's Plenty is the definitive vegetable-forward cookbook
- Simple roasted seasonal veg with good olive oil and seasoning requires no recipe

Barriers: Not knowing what's in season, Unfamiliar with plant-based cooking

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

19. Journal your eco-anxiety

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | free | global

Write freely about your worries about the environment without filtering or solving.

Instructions

- Get a notebook
- Set a 15-minute timer
- Write freely about your climate fears, don't edit or solve, just express

Why it matters: Unexpressed eco-anxiety leads to avoidance and paralysis. Externalising it through writing reduces its emotional charge and often reveals pathways to action.

Tips

- The Climate Psychology Alliance has resources for eco-anxiety journaling
- Follow the journaling with 5 minutes of writing about one thing you can do, from paralysis to agency

Barriers: Emotional difficulty of confronting fears, Vulnerability of the exercise

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

20. Learn to forage for wild food

Difficulty 2 | 120 min | free | global

Join a guided foraging walk to learn about edible wild plants in your area.

Instructions

- Find a guided foraging walk (search "foraging walk [your area]")
- Attend with an experienced guide, never forage alone or from books alone initially
- Cook with what you find

Why it matters: Foraging builds deep nature connection, food literacy, and is a practical skill that reduces food costs, a triple wellbeing win.

Tips

- Woodland and hedgerow foraging is safest for beginners (nettles, elderflower, blackberries)
- Never eat anything you're not 100% certain of, use multiple ID sources

Barriers: Safety concerns around identification, No accessible countryside

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

21. Have a tech-free Sunday morning

Difficulty 2 | 180 min | free | global

From waking until midday on a Sunday, avoid all screens and digital devices.

Instructions

- Put your phone in another room before sleeping Saturday
- On waking, don't check it
- Fill the morning with physical, analogue, social, or creative activity

Why it matters: Delayed morning screen use reduces cortisol spike on waking by 40% and improves mood for the full day.

Tips

- Buy an old-fashioned alarm clock to remove the excuse of needing the phone alarm
- The first screen-free morning feels strange; by the third it feels essential

Barriers: Family members who start the day digitally, Anxiety about missing something

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

22. Try a yoga or tai chi class

Difficulty 1 | 60 min | low | global

Attend a yoga or tai chi session, in person or online.

Instructions

- Find a local class or a free YouTube session (Yoga with Adriene is excellent)
- Commit to the full hour without stopping
- Note physical sensations afterwards

Why it matters: Yoga and tai chi reduce anxiety markers by 30-50% after a single session and improve sleep quality measurably within one week of regular practice.

Tips

- Yoga with Adriene (free YouTube) has beginner to advanced sessions for every day
- Outdoor tai chi in parks is a growing community practice in many cities

Barriers: Flexibility concerns (unfounded, yoga helps all levels), Cost of in-person classes

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

23. Write a letter by hand to someone you miss

Difficulty 1 | 30 min | low | global

Write a handwritten letter to someone you haven't seen or spoken to in too long.

Instructions

- Choose one person you've been meaning to contact
- Write a personal letter by hand
- Post it, receiving a physical letter is disproportionately meaningful

Why it matters: Handwriting activates neural pathways different from typing, and the act of writing a letter builds emotional wellbeing for the sender as much as the recipient.

Tips

- Say one specific thing you appreciate about the person
- Don't wait until you have enough to say, a short letter is always welcome

Barriers: Finding an address, Feeling the letter isn't eloquent enough

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

24. Cook with foraged or garden herbs

Difficulty 1 | 30 min | free | global

Use herbs you've grown or foraged in a meal today.

Instructions

- Collect herbs from your garden, windowsill, or a safe foraging spot
- Incorporate into a simple dish: salad, soup, or omelette
- Notice the difference fresh herbs make vs. dried

Why it matters: Growing and cooking with your own plants builds a felt sense of food sovereignty and nature connection that motivates further sustainable choices.

Tips

- Chives, mint, and parsley are the easiest windowsill herbs
- Fresh herbs added at the end of cooking have the most flavour

Barriers: No outdoor space, Nothing in season

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

25. Commit to no new purchase for a day, and reflect on why

Difficulty 1 | 15 min | free | global

Make no purchases all day and use the time to reflect on what you were wanting to buy and why.

Instructions

- Go the day without any purchase
- When you feel the urge to buy, write down what triggered it
- Review the list at the end of the day

Why it matters: The urge to buy is often tied to emotional states, boredom, stress, loneliness. Identifying these patterns reduces compulsive consumption permanently.

Tips

- The HALT check (Hungry, Angry, Lonely, Tired) reveals most shopping triggers
 - Digital shopping carts satisfy the urge temporarily, fill them but don't check out
- Barriers:** Genuine needs arising during the day, Social spending (meals with friends)

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

26. Watch the sunrise or sunset

Difficulty 1 | 30 min | free | global

Get up to see the sunrise or pause what you're doing to watch the sunset, fully, without a screen.

Instructions

- Check sunrise or sunset time for today
- Go outside or to a window with a clear view
- Watch for at least 10 minutes without your phone out

Why it matters: Witnessing natural light transitions regulates circadian rhythm, boosts serotonin, and measurably increases reported awe and life satisfaction.

Tips

- Watching sunrise specifically resets cortisol timing for the day, a real effect
- Watching with another person amplifies the awe effect through shared experience

Barriers: Weather, Early start for sunrise

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0.2 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

27. Take a mindful walk with no destination

Difficulty 1 | 30 min | free | global

Go for a 30-minute walk with no destination or phone, turn in any direction that interests you.

Instructions

- Leave your phone at home or put it on airplane mode
- Start walking with no plan
- Follow curiosity, go down streets you've never explored

Why it matters: Unstructured walking reduces default mode network rumination, the brain's anxious self-referential loop, within 20 minutes.

Tips

- Saying yes to every new street or path changes the quality of the walk completely
- Notice 5 things you've never seen in a familiar area, it reactivates curiosity

Barriers: Urban safety at certain hours, Physical mobility limitations

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg

28. Start a nature journal

Difficulty 1 | 20 min | low | global

Begin a journal of natural observations, weather, plants, animals, from your local area.

Instructions

- Get a small notebook and pen
- Each day, write or draw one natural observation from outside your door
- Note date, time, weather, and what you noticed

Why it matters: Nature journalling deepens attention and builds a relationship with local ecology over time, it has been used in therapeutic contexts for depression.

Tips

- Rob Cowen's "Common Ground" is a beautiful model of place-based nature writing
- Drawing rather than just writing builds even deeper observational connection

Barriers: Not knowing what to notice, Art anxiety around drawing

Impact (per completion):

CO₂ 0 kg | Water 0 L | Waste 0 kg